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CM: 50K DJB PENSIONERS TO GET CASHLESS HEALTHCARE P3



CONG ANNOUNCES 'VOTE BACHAO, DESH BACHAO' CAMPAIGN P5

JANHVI STRONGLY CONDEMNS AI-ALTERED VIDEO P12

Will annul unilateral decisions, didn't approve modification in Form 6: SC

Refuses interim restraint on CEC, issues notices to EC, Centre

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 5

The Supreme Court on Monday said it will annul decision found not to be in accordance with law while issuing notices to the Election Commission and the Centre on pleas alleging that the poll body took several decisions without the approval of the two election commissioners. The court also made it clear that it has not approved any modifications to Form 6 that was being used by the EC during the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in various states.

The apex court, however, refused to pass any interim direction to restrain Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar from taking any decision till the final disposal of the petition.

A bench of Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana said that it may examine the immunity clause put in the law which gives protection to the CEC even after holding the office.

"We will examine all the decisions. If any decision is not in accordance with the law, we will annul it. You know the power of the court," the bench said as it pointed out that the immunity granted to the CEC is something which even judges don't have.

Senior advocate Vikash Singh, appearing for petitioner Rakesh Kumar Singh, sought a direction in the interim to restrain Kumar from taking any further decisions. He also sought the CEC's suspension, saying that every citizen is feeling unsafe with respect to voting rights.

The bench also issued notice on a connected petition filed by advocate Shailendra Mani Tripathi and tagged it with Singh's petition. The bench said that if the CEC is suspended, the functioning of the Election Commission (EC) will be stalled.

CONTINUED ON P4



» COURT WANTS RECORDS SHOWING WHO MODIFIED FORM 6

CLOSER LOOK

- Pleas allege unilateral EC decision-making by CEC
- Court may examine CEC immunity provisions
- CEC immunity exceeds protections available to judges
- Petitioner sought CEC's suspension pending proceedings
- Court says suspension could stall elections
- EC must follow its constitutional mandate, SC says
- Court demands responses before passing orders
- SC rejects ex-parte action against EC decisions

In fact-check post, EC rejects Rahul's Form 6 claim as 'misleading'

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 5

The Election Commission on Monday termed Congress leader Rahul Gandhi's claim that Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar had "illegally and unilaterally" changed Form 6 as misleading, while the Supreme Court clarified that it had not approved any modification to the voter enrolment form.

Gandhi, in a post on X, alleged that Kumar had altered Form 6 to benefit the BJP and said those involved would be held accountable.

CONTINUED ON P4

Puri, Verma out from BJP's UP RS list, party names eight new faces

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE / BISWAJEET BANERJEE
New Delhi/Lucknow, October 5

The BJP's decision to leave Union Ministers Hardeep Singh Puri and B L Verma out of its Uttar Pradesh Rajya Sabha list on Monday has sent indications of keeping a balance between castes and recalibration of the party's social and regional strategy in the country's politically important state that goes to Assembly polls early next year.

The BJP announced its eight nominations for the Rajya Sabha elections on October 16 from Uttar Pradesh, preferring a combination that gives more importance to caste calculations, organisational loyalty, and regional balancing than to seniority in the Upper House. Union Minister Hardeep Singh Puri, who was expected to be named, is not on the list, indicating a rejig at the Centre also in the days to come.

The candidates named by the party are state minister Dharam Pal Singh, Radhakant

CONTINUED ON P4



KEY POINTS

- BJP focuses on caste and regional balance
- Eight nominees reflect organisational loyalty and social engineering
- Three OBC candidates feature in the BJP's list
- Two Brahmins and two Dalits get representation
- Two women are among BJP's eight nominees

Briefs

GST Council meeting now on October 8

NEW DELHI: The 57th GST Council meeting has been rescheduled for the second time, and the new date is October 8. In an office memorandum, the GST Council Secretariat said that the meeting is being rescheduled due to "unavoidable circumstances".

The Council meeting was scheduled to be held on October 7.

CONTINUED ON P4

SC seeks plan for 135-year-old library

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Monday sought a detailed layout plan from the Centre showing the space proposed for the 135-year-old Central Secretariat Library in Delhi, amid concerns over its relocation under the Central Vista redevelopment project.

A bench of Justices Sanjay Kumar and Sanjeev Sachdeva issued notice to the Centre in a suo motu case concerning the

CONTINUED ON P4

British Airways flight drops 28,000 feet

LONDON: A British Airways flight from London to Chicago made a U-turn and returned to Heathrow on Monday after declaring an emergency following a sudden descent of about 28,000 feet within minutes, according to flight-tracking data. Flight BA295, operated by a Boeing 777-200ER, took off from London Heathrow at 11.50 am

CONTINUED ON P4

CRIME AGAINST WOMEN IN DELHI-NCR

SC stresses on creating fear in minds of miscreants

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 5

The Supreme Court on Monday directed the Delhi Police to strengthen surveillance and patrolling across the National Capital Region, saying women must feel safe travelling on roads and in the metro even late at night. The court said preventing crimes against women should be the priority rather than focusing only on action after an offence has occurred.

A bench of Justices J B Pardiwala and K Vinod Chandran said there was a perception that women were unsafe in Delhi, particularly in vulnerable areas. The court was hearing a suo motu case, titled "In Re: Recent rape incidents in Delhi NCR", in the presence of senior Delhi Police officials and amicus curiae, senior advocate Liz Mathew.

CONTINUED ON P4

PM MODI HOSTS SWISS PRESIDENT PARMELIN

India, Switzerland widen cooperation in trade, investment, mobility and defence

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 5

Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Swiss President Guy Parmelin on Monday agreed to broaden India-Switzerland cooperation in trade, investment, migration, infrastructure, nuclear energy, defence and advanced technologies, with the two sides signing five agreements aimed at improving mobility, expanding economic opportunities and strengthening collaboration in transport and other strategic sectors. The discussions also covered the conflicts in Ukraine and West Asia, with both leaders backing efforts to achieve peace through dialogue and diplomacy. Parmelin began his three-day state visit to India on Monday, his first state visit to the country and his second visit this year after attending the AI Impact Summit in February.

Following his arrival in New Delhi, Parmelin received a ceremonial welcome at Rashtrapati Bhavan before

CONTINUED ON P4



Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Swiss President Guy Parmelin at Hyderabad House ANI

GREAT NICOBAR PROJECT

SC refuses Centre's plea, tells HC to fast-track PIL hearing

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 5

The Supreme Court on Monday refused to entertain the Centre's challenge to a Calcutta High Court order allowing Public Interest Litigations (PILs) questioning alleged violations of the Forest Rights Act in obtaining consent for the Great Nicobar Island infrastructure project.

A bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana noted that the issue was already pending before the High Court and directed it to hear the main case and other connected petitions on November 25 and 26.

Attorney General R Venkataramani questioned the maintainability of the PILs, saying the project's environmental clearance had already been challenged before the National Green Tribunal (NGT).

CONTINUED ON P4

SC gets 3 new judges; working strength goes up to 37

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 5

Three new judges were appointed to the Supreme Court on Monday, taking its working strength to 37, one short of the sanctioned 38.

According to Union Law Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal, Justice Sunita Agarwal, Chief Justice, Gujarat High Court; Justice Devendra Kumar Upadhyaya, Chief Justice, Delhi High Court; and Justice Aparesh Kumar Singh, Chief Justice, Telangana High Court, have been elevated as top court judges.

Meghwal made the announcement in a social media post.

The Supreme Court Collegium had recommended the names on September 28.

While the current working strength of the apex court is 34, once the three new judges formally take the oath, its effective strength will go up to 37.

The top court's sanctioned strength is 38 judges, including the Chief Justice of India. It was recently increased from 34 following the Supreme Court Amendment Act, 2026.

With Justice Sunita Agarwal's appointment, the number of women judges in the top court has gone up to three, including Justice B V Nagarathna, who has been a judge in the top court since August 31, 2021, and

CONTINUED ON P4

UN has become irrelevant: Jaishankar

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 5

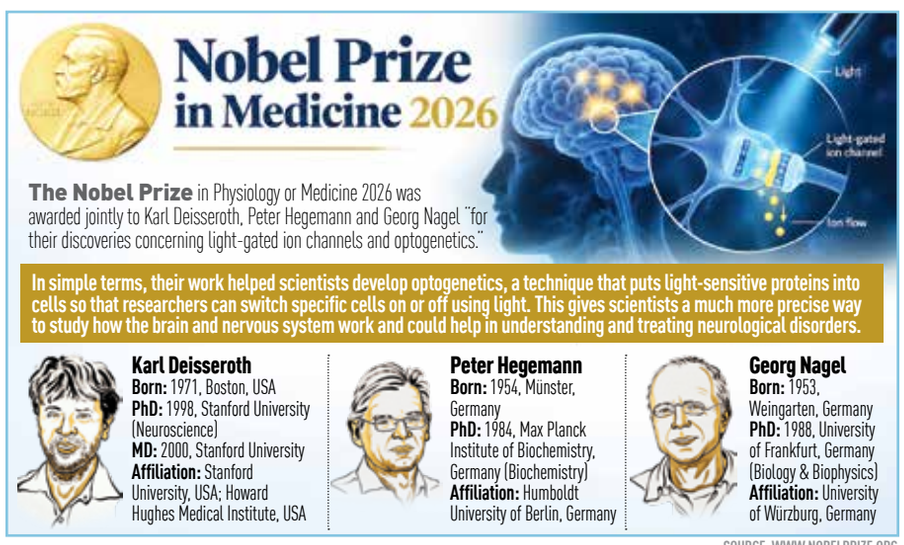
External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar on Monday called for reforms in the United Nations, saying the global body has become irrelevant on several major international issues while its Security Council no longer fully reflects global interests. Speaking at the closing session of the three-day Kautilya Economic Conclave in New Delhi, Jaishankar also described the current global environment as an "age of flux", marked by conflicts,

CONTINUED ON P4

FOR RESEARCH INTO BRAIN ACTIVITY

Optogenetics pioneers win Nobel Medicine Prize

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Stockholm, October 5



The Nobel Prize in Medicine was awarded Monday to three scientists working on the mechanisms the brain uses to switch on, or off, the activity of individual nerve cells.

Karl Deisseroth, 54, Peter Hegemann, 71, and Georg Nagel, 73, have carried out research into light-gated ion channels and optogenetics.

The Nobel Assembly lauded their work, writing on X that the method "is now being used in laboratories around the world to reveal the brain's mysteries".

The assembly said Deisseroth is based at Stanford University in California, while Hegemann is at Humboldt University in Berlin and Nagel at the University of Wurzburg, also in Germany.

Optogenetics opened what the Nobel assembly called a new era in neuroscience, the discovery of a light-controlled switch to turn on and off nerve cells and circuits in the brain to better learn how it works – to start unravelling the pathways that lead to behaviour and disease.

It started when Hegemann explored how a single-celled type of green algae can swim toward light. He and Nagel discovered a particular protein that, when illuminated by blue light, opens a channel to create an electrical impulse. Putting that protein into other cells makes them light-sensitive.

Deisseroth then worked with the gene that controls that protein to create a light-controlled switch for nerve cells in the brains of living mice.

Deisseroth, a self-described night owl, said he was up late in his Northern California home working on papers and emailing his students. He had just gone to lie down when he got the call from the Nobel assembly.

"No real sleep was achieved," he told The Associated

CONTINUED ON P4

India-US trade talks reach 'plateau' with limited room for further concessions: FM

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 5



Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Monday said India and the United States were continuing negotiations on a trade agreement, but the talks appeared to have reached a point where further concessions from either side could be difficult.

"The agreement's negotiations are still ongoing, although we like to believe that both sides have reached a plateau beyond which giving or taking might be very, very difficult," Sitharaman said at the Munich Security Conference. She added that the two countries could still move forward if there was room for compromise.

Sitharaman said a key issue in the negotiations was the trade imbalance in India's favour, with Washington seeking to reduce its deficit. "Naturally, the deficit is there on their side, or the balance is unfavourable for the US, so they would want to reduce that imbalance," she said.

She said trade imbalances have traditionally been addressed through negotiations, including efforts to secure greater market access for goods and services. However, tariffs are increasingly being used as a means of dealing with such imbalances.

CONTINUED ON P4

Heroin worth Rs 50 cr seized, 4 held in interstate drug network

Manufacturing unit busted in Lucknow; main supplier nabbed

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 5



CLOSER LOOK

» **Police recovered 300 grams of heroin and Rs 3 lakh cash from the vehicle. A case was registered at Begumpur police station**

» **During investigation, police traced Hooda's source supplier, Anil alias Bhola (51), a resident of Raghubir Nagar in Delhi. He was arrested from Sonipat on Sept 17, and 501 grams of heroin was recovered from his SUV**

» **Police said the investigation has revealed an interstate network...**

The Delhi Police busted an interstate heroin supply-cum-manufacturing network and arrested four people, recovering over 7 kilograms of the contraband, including over 6 kilograms of freshly manufactured heroin, from Delhi and Uttar Pradesh, an official said on Monday.

The total heroin is estimated to be worth around Rs 50 crore in the international market, he said.

According to police, the special staff of Rohini, during a raid on Sunday, recovered over 3 kilograms of material used in manufacturing heroin, including 2.5 kg sodium and 787 grams of acetic anhydride, besides equipment used at an illegal manufacturing facility in Lucknow.

"The investigation began after a team received information about the movement of narcotics in the Begumpur area. On September 16, the team intercepted an SUV in Sector 32 in Begumpur and arrested Laxman Hooda (58), of Haryana, while he was arriving to deliver heroin," a senior police officer said.

Police recovered 300 grams of heroin and Rs 3 lakh cash from the vehicle. A case was registered at Begumpur police station. During investigation, police traced Hooda's source supplier, Anil alias Bhola (51), a resident of Raghubir Nagar in Delhi. He was arrested from Sonipat on September 17, and 501 grams of heroin was recovered from his SUV.

The officer said Anil has previously been involved in 12 cases and was earlier arrested in an NDPS case registered at Bhalswa Dairy police station in 2025. After being granted interim bail, he allegedly failed to surrender before the jail authorities and was subsequently declared a proclaimed offender by a court.

"Further investigation and technical surveillance led police to an illegal heroin manufacturing facility in Sita Colony Jankipuram in Lucknow. On October 4, a police team raided the facility and arrested Bablu (35), a resident of Bareilly in Uttar Pradesh. The raid resulted in the recovery of over 6 kg of freshly manufactured heroin," the officer said.

Police also seized 2.504 kg of sodium, 787 grams of acetic anhydride, a tub, gas cylinder, mixer grinder, utensils, polythene, electronic weighing machine, wooden basket and other material allegedly used for manufacturing heroin. Based on information provided by Bablu, police traced Ruksar Ali alias Raju, the main source supplier and owner of the manufacturing facility, to Bareilly. He was arrested after a pursuit spanning around 120 km, police said. Police said Bablu had previously been involved in an NDPS case, while Ruksar Ali had three previous NDPS cases against him.

Police said the investigation has revealed an interstate network extending from Delhi-NCR to Uttar Pradesh, with the accused involved in sourcing, manufacturing and supplying heroin. Further investigation is underway to identify the complete supply chain, financial links and procurement.

New Barapullah corridor faces traffic snarl

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, October 5



'EIGHT LANES CONVERGE INTO THREE, CHOKING BARAPULLAH STRETCH...'

The newly opened Barapullah Phase-III corridor witnessed heavy congestion on Monday morning, with commuters reporting prolonged delays on the Mayur Vihar-AIIMS route and traffic police identifying a lane-merging point on the older Barapullah flyover as the key trouble spot.

The congestion was particularly visible around Mayur Vihar Phase-I Metro station and the entry points to the Phase-III elevated corridor. Some commuters reported being stuck in slow-moving traffic for extended periods during the morning rush, raising concerns over whether the new link is delivering the intended improvement in connectivity during peak hours. Delhi Traffic Police said the problem is primarily linked to the road geometry at the Old Barapullah Flyover. According to the department, traffic coming from multiple approaches is eventually being funnelled into the three-lane older flyover.

The new Phase-III elevated section on the Mayur Vihar side has roughly three lanes. The loops leading towards Sarai Kale Khan and the DND side also have around three lanes each, while the existing Barapullah flyover has three lanes. Traffic police said the combined movement from approximately eight to nine lanes converges at one point before entering the three-lane stretch, creating a significant capacity mismatch.

"Traffic of approximately 8-9 lanes is converging into 3 lanes at a single point on Old Barapullah flyover," the traffic police said.

Personnel have been deployed at the merging locations to regulate the flow and prevent further build-up. Traffic from Phase-III is also being directed towards NH-24 and the DND side as part of efforts to distribute vehicle movement.

The department also flagged a problem with navigation data, saying Google Maps was continuing to display the route as largely free-flowing despite the actual congestion on the ground.

The traffic situation prompted motorists to share their experiences online. One commuter reported remaining in bumper-to-bumper traffic for around half an hour while covering only about two kilometres. Another described the route as problematic during the morning peak and advised motorists to avoid it at that time.

CISF jawan attacked during NSUI protest

New Delhi, October 5

A CISF constable suffered a minor injury to his right elbow after a protester allegedly attacked him with a knife during an NSUI protest at Jantar Mantar on Monday, officials said. The National Students' Union of India (NSUI), the Congress' student wing, staged the protest demanding the resignation and arrest of CEC Gyanesh Kumar over alleged electoral irregularities.

The constable, identified as Bikram Kumar, was deployed for law and order duty when he was allegedly attacked while taking a protester away from a barricade, officials said.

Kumar said the attacker appeared to target his neck, but he moved away, causing the knife to slash his hand instead. The protester was detained and legal action was being initiated. The injured constable was taken to RML Hospital, where he received treatment. PTI

ACP Bhagat accused of harassing journalist gets Addl DCP charge

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 5

'MOVE WAS ROUTINE, WITH THE OFFICERS' ELEVATION PROPOSAL SENT BEFORE THE ALLEGATIONS SURFACED'

Delhi Police ACP Vivek Bhagat, who has been accused by a woman journalist of sexual harassment during an anti-Election Commission protest, was on Monday assigned the current duty charge of Additional Deputy Commissioner of Police (Addl DCP), even as complaints by three women journalists are being examined by the Crime Branch.

Bhagat, currently posted as SDPO, Connaught Place, is among 12 Selection Grade DANIPS officers given the additional charge of Addl DCP through an order issued on October 5. Eleven other officers were also included in the order.

Senior police officials said the move was part of a routine administrative exercise and that the proposal for the officers' elevation had been sent much before the allegations emerged.

According to the order, the arrangement is temporary and concerns only the routine duties of the Addl DCP post.

The officers will not be authorised to exercise statutory powers attached to the post and will not receive additional pay or benefits associated with a regular promotion. The arrangement will end once the Ministry of Home Affairs fills the Addl DCP positions on a regular basis and can also be withdrawn at any time.

Bhagat is among officers from the 2018 batch listed in the order. Other officers assigned the current duty charge include Dr Vikas Sheokand, A Venkatesh, Gursewak Singh, Renu Lata, Vidushi Kaushik, Manu Himanshu, Sakaria Mihir Pravinbhai, Garima Tiwari, Ashish Kumar, Manish Ladla and Rohit Gupta.

The order has come days after three women journalists alleged sexual harassment and manhandling by police personnel while covering the October 3 protest at Jantar Mantar against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

One of the journalists alleged that Bhagat behaved inappropriately with her after she questioned the absence of women police personnel during the detention of protesters.

Crime Branch inquiry into three women's complaints is underway after allegations against an ACP, while CJP, Congress and Press Club criticised police response.

PREPARE FOR BACKUP LEADERSHIP

AAP's Bharadwaj announces Oct 10 protest & cautions supporters

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 5

Delhi AAP chief Saurabh Bharadwaj on Monday said a protest will be held at Jantar Mantar on October 10 against the Election Commission and asked organisations supporting it to prepare backup leadership and communication plans in case their leaders are detained.

Bharadwaj said organisations should have second- and third-level leadership ready in case their top leaders are arrested, adding that district and assembly-level leaders could also be detained a day before the proposed protest.

In a video on X, Bharadwaj claimed, "Leaders and organisers of the protest could be arrested in false cases ahead of the demonstration and urged political parties and organisations to ensure that the protest continues even if their senior leaders are detained." "This protest is bigger than any leader, political party or organisation. This is a protest of 140 crore Indians," he added.

He asked organisations to have communication plans ready if leaders were detained or messaging platforms were blocked.

"When a leader is present in a protest, he talks to the police and authorities and keeps the protest peaceful. But without a leader, it becomes difficult to keep the protest peaceful," Bharadwaj said.

He appealed to organisers to ensure the protest remained democratic, constitutional, legal and peaceful "even if arrests take place".

Bharadwaj said the movement should have contingency plans for both leadership and communication, including alternative channels if regular platforms become unavailable.

"After one leadership, there should be another leadership which gives leadership to the whole protest and keeps it peaceful," he added.

The AAP and student outfits such as AISA, NSUI and IYC held protests on Friday, Saturday and Sunday, demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged irregularities in the SIR process.

NSUI stages 'living dead' protest over 'Vote Chori'

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, October 5



The National Students' Union of India (NSUI) staged a symbolic "living dead" protest at Jantar Mantar on Monday, alleging that voters' rights and the democratic process were being undermined through what it termed "Vote Chori".

The protest was led by NSUI national president Vinod Jakhar, with demonstrators portraying themselves as "living dead" to highlight their concerns over the electoral process. The protesters demanded the resignation and arrest of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

Several NSUI members, including Jakhar, were detained by the Delhi Police during the demonstration. The student organisation condemned the detentions, maintaining that its members were protesting peacefully and seeking accountability from the Election Commission.

Jakhar said the protest was intended to convey that the alleged denial of voters' rights undermined the meaning of democracy. He also accused the government of using police action instead of addressing questions raised over the electoral process.

NSUI media in-charge Ravi Hanuman Pandey condemned the detention of the organisation's national president and other members, saying that students raising questions about the electoral process should not be silenced.

The organisation said it would continue its campaign against what it described as "Vote Chori" and seek greater accountability.

5-year-old boy dies after falling from goalpost

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 5

A five-year-old boy died after he allegedly fell from a goalpost while playing football inside the Akshardham temple complex in east Delhi, police said on Monday.

The incident took place around 4:30 pm on Sunday, when the child was playing football inside the campus and climbed the goalpost pole before accidentally falling from it, according to preliminary inquiry.

The boy sustained injuries in the fall and was taken for medical treatment, but died, police said.

The child's parents, residents of Akshardham campus, reported no foul play. His father, a security guard there for 15 years, received the body.

JNUSU announces march amid ongoing indefinite hunger strike

Union seeks withdrawal of CPO Manual, GSCASH revival, hostel reforms

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, October 5



THE UNION HAS ALSO SOUGHT REINSTATEMENT OF THE JNU ENTRANCE EXAMINATION, IMPROVEMENT OF HOSTEL INFRA...

Jawaharlal Nehru University Students' Union (JNUSU) said on Monday that its office-bearers and 14 other students were continuing an indefinite hunger strike over a range of demands concerning student rights, campus infrastructure and administrative accountability.

The union said the hunger strike, which began on October 3, included JNUSU president Aditi, vice-president Gopika and general secretary Sunil. Its demands include the withdrawal of the CPO Manual, revocation of the rustication of JNUSU office-bearers, reinstatement of the Gender Sensitisation Committee Against Sexual Harassment (GSCASH) and an independent inquiry into alleged recruitment irregularities involving the university's IQAC.

The union has also sought the reinstatement of the JNU Entrance Examination, improvement of hostel infrastructure, functional mess and Wi-Fi facilities, expansion of library seating and repairs to campus roads and other facilities.

In a statement, the JNUSU alleged that the university administration had sent its Chief Security Officer to the hunger-strikers and that the officer threatened the union with an extension of the rustication period. The union also alleged that medical checkups of the protesting office-bearers had been denied.

Other demands include reforming the Equal Opportunity Cell in line with the principles of the Rohith Act, ensuring hostel accommodation until PhD thesis submission, implementing reservation and institutional provisions for transgender students, auditing mess bills and increasing MCM scholarships.

The union said it had sought dialogue with the Vice-Chancellor but had received no response. It has announced a "Fight Back JNU March" from Sabarmati T Point to the East Gate at 9 pm on October 9.

'Allegations of assault on female protesters baseless': Delhi Police

New Delhi, October 5



The Delhi Police on Monday rejected allegations on social media that female protesters were subjected to physical assault during the recent demonstrations in the national capital, saying they were handled by female personnel and treated with dignity in accordance with prescribed procedures.

New Delhi DCP Sachin Sharma said the allegations were "baseless and misleading" and did not reflect the actual sequence of events. "Some social media handles are claiming that female protesters were subjected to physical assault. These allegations are baseless and misleading. Female protesters are handled by female staff and are treated with dignity and due regard," Sharma said in a post on X.

"Male protesters who were detained were released within the stipulated time period, following due process of law. Any claim suggesting otherwise is factually incorrect and does not reflect the actual sequence of events," the DCP said. The police response came amid a series of protests in and around Jantar Mantar over the past few days by student groups, political parties and activists demanding the resignation of CEC Gyanesh Kumar over alleged irregularities in the functioning of the Election Commission and SIR exercise.

AISA members had earlier alleged that its national president Neha Bora was picked up during a protest march towards Jantar Mantar and taken to Narela Industrial Area police station. They had also alleged that she was taken away in a private vehicle without an official number plate and that no woman police officer was present in the vehicle. PTI

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CM: 50K DJB pensioners to get cashless healthcare

Single-window system to simplify treatment, medical tests...

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, October 5

More than 50,000 Delhi Jal Board pensioners and family pensioners will no longer have to pay medical expenses upfront and undergo lengthy reimbursement procedures, with Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday launching a cashless healthcare facility under the 'Seva Sankalp Abhiyan'.

The facility will provide cashless treatment and medical tests through a single-window system, aimed at making access to healthcare simpler for retired DJB employees and their families.

Launching the initiative, Gupta said pensioners had spent a significant part of their lives serving Delhi and deserved easier access to healthcare after retirement.

"Pensioners will now be spared the burden of paying from their own pockets and going through lengthy reimbursement procedures for treatment," she said.

The chief minister said the earlier system required pensioners to first bear medical expenses themselves and subsequently apply for reimbursement, a process that could be particularly difficult for elderly beneficiaries.



GUPTA SAID GOVT HAD FACED SEVERAL CHALLENGES WHILE IMPLEMENTING NEW SYSTEM

Gupta said the government had faced several challenges while implementing the new system but worked towards resolving them. "The government's objective is not merely to launch schemes, but to create systems that make people's lives easier," she said.

She added that the initiative was also a mark of recognition for the contribution of retired DJB employees who had served the city for years.

Delhi Water Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said the new facility was aimed at ensuring that retired employees did not have to navigate cumbersome paperwork to access medical care.

"Delhi Jal Board employees spent their entire lives serving Delhiites, now it is our responsibility to look after their healthcare," Singh said.

He said more than 50,000 pensioners and family pensioners would benefit from the initiative, with the single-window mechanism simplifying the process of accessing treatment and medical services.

"This is not merely a medical facility, but also a reflection of the respect and sense of responsibility towards employees who made a significant contribution to providing water and sewer services to households across Delhi for years," Singh said.

The cashless healthcare facility is part of the Delhi government's broader 'Seva Sankalp Abhiyan' and is intended to reduce both the financial burden and administrative difficulties faced by retired DJB employees while seeking treatment.

Delhi Jal Board Vice Chairman and MLA Satish Upadhyay, MCD Mayor Pravesh Wahi, Delhi government Principal Secretary Rajeev Verma, DJB CEO Sajjan Singh Yadav, board members and senior officials were present at the launch.

The government said the initiative would make healthcare services more accessible to pensioners and their families while providing them with a more convenient and dignified system of medical care.

AALI VILLAGE

Congress opposes demolition, seeks rehabilitation of 25,000 residents

New Delhi, October 5

Delhi Congress president Devender Yadav on Monday opposed the proposed demolition of houses in Aali village, demanding that around 25,000 residents be provided alternative accommodation before any displacement.

Yadav, who visited the village in south Delhi and met the residents, claimed around 1,800-2,000 houses were facing demolition and alleged that the BJP government and the DDA were displacing people without making arrangements for their rehabilitation.

"The BJP government should tell where they will go after uprooting 25,000 people of Aali village. The government should stop destroying the poor without rehabilitating them," Yadav said in a statement.

He demanded that the residents, who he said had been living in the area for 70-80 years, should not be displaced without being provided in-situ housing under the "Jahan Jhuggi, Wahi Makaan" policy followed by the previous Congress government, the statement read. Yadav accused BJP government of demolishing Aali village homes without rehabilitation or compensation. PTI

'PG safety, rents on agenda as Delhi govt consults operators'

Framework to focus on security, transparency, standards

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, October 5

The Delhi government on Monday held a stakeholder consultation with paying guest (PG) owners, operators and managers as part of its ongoing exercise to frame a comprehensive regulatory framework for student accommodation in the capital.

Education Minister Ashish Sood held discussions with PG operators to understand operational challenges and their concerns while working on regulations aimed at improving safety, transparency and basic living standards for students staying in PG accommodations.

"Following the recent unfortunate incident in Delhi, the process of regulating PGs and formulating new laws for them is ongoing," Sood said.

He said the government was consulting different stakeholders before finalising the proposed legislation. "A few days ago, I engaged to understand the concerns of the students and residents living in PGs. Today, I met with PG operators, owners, and managers to understand their perspectives and stakes," he said.

"Before drafting any new law, our government is engaging with everyone through stakeholder consultations. This is true participatory governance, the very model of participatory governance we are working on," Sood added.



> **EDUCATION MINISTER ASHISH SOOD HELD DISCUSSIONS WITH PG OPERATORS TO UNDERSTAND OPERATIONAL CHALLENGES, CONCERNS**

The minister said the proposed framework would seek to balance the concerns of operators with the need to ensure safe and affordable accommodation for students. "Our concern is to ensure that people have access to safe, secure, reliable, and reasonably priced PG accommodations in Delhi," he said.

Sood said more than six lakh students migrate to Delhi every year, making regulation of student housing an important concern for the government. "Providing safe housing to the majority of them who reside in PGs is our responsibility. As part of that responsibility, today's discussions were held with the PG operators during this stakeholder consultation," he said.

The consultation follows a meeting Sood held with students living in PGs on September 8, during which they raised concerns over arbitrary electricity charges, high rents, inadequate security and landlords whose credentials had not been verified.

On September 15, Sood chaired the first meeting of a 20-member High-Powered Committee on Student Accommodation and Safety. The panel discussed proposals including standardised rental agreements, compulsory municipal registration through a centralised 'GovPG' portal, structural and fire safety inspections and mechanisms to ensure fair pricing.

The government is now working towards finalising the regulatory framework and guidelines in the coming weeks, with the proposed measures aimed at protecting the interests of more than six lakh students who move to Delhi for education each year.

CM reviews Sakhi Centre

Monthly reports ordered on FIR status, police action, assistance

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 5

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday inspected the Sakhi One Stop Centre at Lok Nayak Hospital and directed officials to ensure time-bound follow-up of complaints involving women and girls affected by violence.

Gupta ordered all Sakhi centres in Delhi to submit detailed monthly reports to the Chief Minister's Office, covering police intimation, FIR status, action against accused and assistance provided to victims.

"A woman seeking help must receive not just assistance, but dignity, safety and effective legal support," Gupta said.

She also directed separate and confidential record-keeping of POCSO cases involving girls, with regular monitoring of police action, FIRs, arrests and subsequent legal proceedings.

DIRECTED SEPARATE AND CONFIDENTIAL RECORD-KEEPING OF POCSO CASES INVOLVING GIRLS, WITH REGULAR MONITORING...

The Chief Minister reviewed counselling, medical assistance, legal aid, police support and temporary shelter facilities available at the centre. She said women reaching the centre in distress should be provided a safe environment and their concerns addressed sensitively.

Gupta further directed officials to record delays in police action and escalate such cases to senior officers for prompt resolution.

She stressed that the effectiveness of the system should be assessed not merely by the number of cases registered, but by the assistance provided and action taken thereafter.

L-G Sandhu reviews campus safety

Seeks stronger policing, transport links around campuses

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, October 5

Delhi Lieutenant Governor Sardar TS Sandhu on Monday reviewed student safety and campus security with heads of GNCTD universities and senior officials, focusing on dark stretches, inadequate lighting, last-mile connectivity, CCTV cameras and security around public transport points.

Sandhu directed authorities to strengthen last-mile connectivity by increasing the frequency and augmenting U Special and Ladies Special buses, regulating battery rickshaws and autos, and promoting the Metro Saarthi and One Delhi apps and the Durga Scheme. Bus services to and from Metro stations are to be increased, particularly between 8 am and 11 am and 5 pm and 8 pm.

Representatives of GGSIPU, DTU, NSUT, DPSRU, IGDTUW, DSEU and AUD, along with senior officials from the MCD, Delhi Police, PWD, Education, Transport and Traffic Police, attended the meeting.

CONCERNS WERE ALSO RAISED OVER LIQUOR SHOPS NEAR CAMPUSES

University representatives flagged dark and isolated stretches, malfunctioning CCTV cameras, poor street lighting, traffic congestion, parking constraints, inadequate metro connectivity and shortage of security personnel. Concerns were also raised over liquor outlets near campuses, e-rickshaws, open urinals, DDA parks and vacant plots with overgrown vegetation, broken boundary walls and the need for dedicated Pink Booths.

Sandhu stressed sustained multi-agency coordination to ensure a safe academic environment, particularly for women students. He directed regular foot, motorcycle and PCR patrolling, with vulnerable stretches, isolated lanes, parks and poorly lit areas identified for visible deployment of women police personnel.

He also directed regular interaction between police officers and university authorities, prompt action on complaints of stalking, harassment and eve-teasing, and stronger security around metro stations, bus stops, auto and e-rickshaw stands and cab pick-up points. Universities were asked to establish 'Action Bodies' involving deans, faculty, students and hostel wardens to address student concerns.

On infrastructure, the L-G directed the PWD, DDA and MCD to repair non-functional street lights, illuminate dark spots and set timelines for the smart street pole project. Agencies were also asked to remove encroachments near campuses and in adjoining parks. Universities were directed to identify and verify localities and houses being used as paying guest accommodations in consultation with Delhi Police.

Min: 'Govt directs tighter security at Puja pandals'

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 5

The Delhi government has directed officials to step up security and civic arrangements at Durga Puja pandals, including CCTV cameras and scanners, while urging additional cultural programmes and improved facilities at Chhath Puja venues this year.

With the festive season approaching, Delhi Tourism Minister Kapil Mishra asked district magistrates to regularly monitor arrangements at Durga Puja pandals and cultural venues, while departments have been directed to ensure drinking water, medical teams, sanitation, electricity, traffic management and crowd control.

Mishra, chairman of the special committee for Durga Puja celebrations, chaired a review meeting Monday, directing officials to ensure adequate CCTV cameras and scanners at pandals and maintain continuous vigilance in coordination with police and the administration.

> **IRRIGATION AND FLOOD CONTROL DEPT WILL ALSO MAKE ARRANGEMENTS FOR IMMERSION PITS...**

The minister directed all necessary no-objection certificates and permissions for Durga Puja celebrations be processed through the single-window system within the stipulated timeline, according to an official statement.

The irrigation and flood control department will also make arrangements for immersion pits and water supply at idol immersion sites for dignified conduct of ritual proceedings. Artificial or temporary ponds and tanks will be arranged for idol immersion, along with special arrangements for cleaning and removing remains, the statement said.

Briefs

Teen detained for fatally stabbing minor

FARIDABAD: Faridabad police have detained a 14-year-old boy for allegedly stabbing a 12-year-old boy to death during a scuffle while the two were playing in Sector 56, officials said on Monday.

The accused has been sent to a correction centre, while an investigation is underway. Police said he fled the spot with the knife after the incident on Sunday evening.

According to Iqbal, a scuffle broke out while the boys played, and Kannu was stabbed in the chest. He was taken to hospital, where doctors declared him dead.

11 held in fake job placement racket: Police

NEW DELHI: Two fake placement call centres allegedly duping job seekers by offering lucrative employment in return for registration and processing fees were busted near Shadipur Metro Station, with 11 operatives apprehended, police said on Monday.

The centres, operating from a building in Ranjit Nagar, allegedly obtained job seekers' data from online recruitment platforms and posed as recruiters. They demanded fees of Rs 3,500, Rs 1,400 and Rs 1,200 under different pretexts before cutting contact without providing jobs.

Six people, including four women, were apprehended from one centre, while five men were held from the other. Police seized 13 computers and five mobile phones.

Mayor's '5-star' remark for MCD school's midday meal kitchen draws flak

New Delhi, October 5

Delhi Mayor Pravesh Wahi on Monday said kitchens supplying mid-day meals to MCD schools were as clean and well-equipped as "five-star hotels" after inspecting the Maitreyi Mid-Day Meal Kitchen in Pooth village. He checked food preparation, hygiene and ingredients, and tasted kadhi-chawal prepared for morning-shift schools. Puri-sabzi was prepared for evening-shift schools.

Wahi said there would be no compromise on food quality and announced weekly surprise inspections of mid-day meal kitchens. Under the PM POSHAN Abhiyaan, kitchens receive food ingredients and financial assistance.

AAP councillor and Standing Committee member Praveen Kumar rejected the claim, saying most MCD schools were in poor condition and promising to inspect school canteens. Congress councillor Nazia Danish also questioned the claims, asking whether BJP leaders send their children to municipal schools.

Danish challenged the civic administration to show a school kitchen for inspection and questioned the closure of several Atal Canteens soon after their launch. PTI

EIGHT-MEMBER PMU TO OVERSEE URBAN MANAGEMENT

GNIDA seeks PMU to improve AQI measures

DIPIKA KIROLA
Greater Noida, October 5



The Greater Noida Industrial Development Authority (GNIDA) is set to hire a Project Management Unit (PMU) to oversee urban and industrial area management, with strengthening pollution-control measures among its key responsibilities.

The two-year contract, extendable by another two years based on performance, requires the selected agency to deploy eight full-time experts at GNIDA offices. The team is expected to be in place within a month of signing the agreement.

The last date for submitting bids is October 14, while technical and financial bids will be opened on October 15.

The PMU will assist GNIDA with planning, procurement, project monitoring and execution across its jurisdiction, covering 95 sectors and 124 villages. It will also work to strengthen the authority's institutional capacity.

A key task will be to review and improve the existing air-pollution monitoring system in line with guidelines issued by the Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM). The experts will monitor implementation of pollution-control action plans and compliance with statutory requirements.

CAQM's action plan for Greater Noida emphasises scientific road-dust management, mechanised sweeping, timely road repairs and redevelopment, dust suppression, utility restoration and maintenance of paved shoulders.

It also recommends monthly workshops, removal of legacy dust, water sprinklers, anti-smog guns and GPS-based monitoring.

The tender requires the PMU's air-quality expert to have at least six years' experience in pollution control, environmental studies, climate change and sustainability.

The move comes as Noida's AQI stood at 268, Ghaziabad's at 248 and Greater Noida's at 171 on Monday.

POLLUTION CONTROL

- The PMU will assist GNIDA with planning, procurement, proj monitoring & execution, covering 95 sectors & 124 villages. It will work to strengthen the authority's institutional capacity
- Last date for submitting bids is Oct 14; technical and financial bids will be opened on Oct15
- CAQM's action plan for Greater Noida emphasises scientific road-dust management, mechanised sweeping, timely road repairs and redevelopment, dust suppression, utility restoration

From page 1

SC

"Who will conduct the elections?" the bench asked, adding that the EC has to work in accordance with the constitutional mandate.

Singh submitted that the two election commissioners can discharge the functions.

The bench stated that it has to seek the responses of the persons concerned before passing any order.

Singh submitted that the court should then order that the EC should take decisions only unanimously or by majority. The bench said it cannot pass any order ex parte and needs to see the decisions taken by the poll panel.

Singh stated that the electoral roll itself has been "vitiated" because of the unilateral decisions by the CEC. Justice Bagchi then asked whether the court can pass such an order ex parte, without hearing the respondents.

"If records show some decision was not unanimous, etc., we will injunct those decisions and say they are ultra vires. Can we, ex parte, come to a decision that all decisions were unilateral? We expect them to respond in a clear, transparent manner," Justice Bagchi said.

Singh claimed that the press release issued by the EC in the aftermath of the controversy triggered by a news report amounted to admitting to what the article stated.

CJI Kant said that the court cannot pass an order by relying solely on newspaper reports, and it has to look into the responses of the EC and the Centre.

The Indian Express recently reported that Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi objected on record at least 14 times over the last 10 months to decisions and orders on the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls that they said were issued without their knowledge or recommendation.

The bench issued notices to the EC and the Centre on Singh's petition and asked them to furnish all relevant details in their responses.

The top court pointed out that the relief sought in the petition filed by advocate Tripathi is all jumbled up. It asked senior advocate Menaka Guruswamy, appearing for Tripathi, to amend the prayers, if required.

The Supreme Court also said that it has not approved any modifications to Form 6 being used by the Election Commission (EC) during the SIR of electoral rolls in various states.

Form 6 is an application through which an eligible person seeks inclusion in the electoral roll. The bench, led by CJI Kant, said, "Any modification to Form 6 has not been approved by us. Let's be clear. When records are produced, we would like to see who has modified it".

During the hearing on Tripathi's PIL, Guruswamy said there were no infirmities in the petitioner's PIL and raised concerns over changes made to Form 6, which is used by eligible citizens to apply for inclusion of their names in electoral rolls.

The bench issued notice on Tripathi's plea and tagged the matter with another PIL filed by Patna resident Rakesh Kumar Singh on the issue.

Tripathi's plea, filed through advocate Chand Qureshi, has alleged that the CEC's actions violate the statutory requirement of collective decision-making. The plea also seeks initiation of criminal proceedings against the CEC and other officials for breach of official duty.

Concerns over the handling of electoral roll revisions in Goa and West Bengal were also mentioned in the plea, which alleged that the software lacked the feature to restore 97 eligible electors in Goa despite directions for their verification.

In West Bengal, the petitioner claimed that more than 16.10 lakh appeals were filed in the EC's name against voters whose names were restored by judicial officers. The other two election commissioners and the West Bengal chief electoral officer were not aware of these appeals, nor did they authorise them, the plea claims.

EC rejects Rahul

Responding with a fact check, the EC said the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) order for Bihar was issued on June 24, 2025, with the unanimous approval of the Commission.

The poll panel said the order was upheld by the Supreme Court in its May 27, 2026 judgment. It also referred to its September 25 press note, which stated that the declaration attached to Form 6 for the SIR had been upheld by the court.

The EC later withdrew from its online portals in non-SIR states the declaration seeking parents' details from applicants seeking enrolment.

Form 6 is used by people applying for inclusion in electoral rolls. The online form and the attached declaration had a single OTP process for both documents, rather than separate OTPs, leading to questions over whether the declaration formed part of Form 6.

On Monday, however, a bench headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant said the court had not approved any changes to Form 6. "Any modification to Form 6 has not been approved by us. Let's be clear," the bench said, adding that it would examine records to determine who had made any modification.

The EC also rejected claims that it had removed its September 26 press note from its website, sharing its link to show that it remained available.

Puri, Verma

Ojha, Prakash Pal, Vidyasagar Sonkar, Gopi Krishna Pandey, Priyanka Singh Rawat, Ram Pratap Singh Chauhan and Shruti Gangwar.

Both Puri and Verma, whose tenure in the Rajya Sabha expires next month, were left off the list despite being members of the Union Council of Ministers.

The list provides the BJP with a chance to update its presence from the state of Uttar Pradesh and send a message to its social base. The list includes three OBCs, two Brahmins, two Dalits, and one Thakur, and also two women.

OBCs play an important role in the alliance. BJP MLA Dharam Pal Singh from Aonla in Bareilly belongs to the Lodh caste, which carries some weight in the Rohilkhand and Bundelkhand regions. The BJP's connection with the Lodh community is known to be associated with the politics of erstwhile chief minister Kalyan Singh, who was considered to be one of the tallest leaders of the OBCs in the BJP in Uttar Pradesh.

The other two OBCs are Prakash Pal, who heads the OBC Morcha of the BJP in the state, and Shruti Gangwar from Bareilly. Shruti Gangwar is the daughter of Jharkhand Governor and former Union Minister Santosh Gangwar.

The Brahmin quota nomination includes Radhakant Ojha, a lawyer from Prayagraj and brother of ex-minister Shivakant Ojha, and Gopi Krishna Pandey from Kanpur, who has served in the BJP's farmers' and youth wings. Regarding the Dalit quota nomination, the BJP has opted for Priyanka Singh Rawat, the former MP and state vice-president from Barabanki, and Vidyasagar Sonkar from Jaunpur, who is a former state general secretary and MLC.

The eighth candidate, Ram Pratap Singh Chauhan from Agra, is a BJP state general secretary and experienced in election campaign management.

The BJP has won three seats in the UP Rajya Sabha election so far. In total, Uttar Pradesh elects 31 members to the Rajya Sabha, which is a key state for the BJP's calculations in the national sphere. There are ten seats that will have elections scheduled on October 16. The term of the incumbent members ends on November 25.

Some of the BJP leaders who will retire are Puri, Arun Singh, Geeta Shakya, Neeraj Shekhar, Brijlal, B L Verma and Seema Dwivedi, along with Samajwadi Party leader Ram Gopal Yadav and BSP's Ramji Gautam.

There is one additional vacancy in the Rajya Sabha that has remained so since September 11, after the resignation of former Uttar Pradesh deputy chief minister Dinesh Sharma after he was appointed as the Lieutenant Governor of Andaman and Nicobar Islands.

The BJP's decision to field eight new faces from Uttar Pradesh for the Rajya Sabha elections also reflects a carefully calibrated mix of caste, regional representation and gender, with the party looking beyond established names as it prepares for the 2027 Assembly elections.

Ten seats from Uttar Pradesh are falling vacant, with the BJP expected to secure eight based on its strength in the state Assembly. The composition of the list indicates that the party has given considerable weight to social engineering.

The choices are significant in the context of the BJP's political contest with the Samajwadi Party, which has built its campaign around the PDA formulation of backward classes, Dalits and minorities. The BJP's list gives representation to several backward and Dalit communities while retaining representation among its traditional upper-caste support base.

Dharampal Singh, a Lodh leader and Cabinet minister in the Yogi Adityanath government, is also the BJP's state organisational secretary. His inclusion gives representation to the Lodh community, an important OBC group in western and central Uttar Pradesh. His nomination also underlines the BJP's preference for leaders with organisational experience.

Prakash Pal, a BJP regional office-bearer, represents the Pal community, while Vidyasagar Sonkar is a prominent Dalit leader and former MP and MLC. Radhakant Ojha and Gopi Krishna Pandey provide Brahmin representation, while Ram Pratap Singh Chauhan represents the Rajput community.

The regional spread of the nominees is another element of the list. Rather than relying on nationally prominent leaders, the BJP has picked leaders with links to the party's state organisation and different social and regional constituencies.

The BJP's choice carries significance beyond the Rajya Sabha arithmetic. By choosing eight relatively new faces, including organisational leaders and two women, the party has used the nominations to signal representation across communities and regions while simultaneously giving its state-level leadership greater space in Parliament. The BJP is certain to win seven seats and is pushing for an eighth. All eight candidates are likely to file their nominations in Lucknow today in the presence of Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath and State Unit Chief Pankaj Chaudhary.

SC stresses

"We must ensure that every woman in NCT of Delhi should feel safe even at 11 pm whether travelling on the roads or in metro," the bench said.

The judges asked police to increase surveillance and beat patrolling at locations where women may be vulnerable, including bus stands, railway and metro stations, parks, schools and colleges. They also asked authorities to identify areas with poor lighting and inadequate security.

"What is important is to prevent a crime, not what you do after a crime is committed," the bench said, adding that existing deficiencies should not create opportunities for offenders.

The court also questioned the effectiveness of CCTV cameras without continuous monitoring. It asked police to consider whether surveillance systems were being watched adequately through control rooms.

Justice Pardiwala called on the police to act firmly against those likely to commit offences. "Don't let us down. Rise to the occasion," he said, describing crimes against women as a major challenge for the police department.

The bench also referred to the need for police to maintain regular contact with residents. "People should not run away from you. People should come and talk to you," it said.

The court referred to the 2012 Delhi gangrape case while discussing the role of illegal eateries and liquor consumption in some areas. It said police needed to identify places where anti-social elements gather and take preventive action.

The amicus curiae raised the issue of beat patrolling and vacancies in the police force. The bench said recruitment should be pursued alongside stronger policing at the grassroots level. The court also cautioned police to remain vigilant during the upcoming festival period, when crowds and public activity increase.

The Supreme Court had taken suo motu cognisance on September 28 of reports concerning crimes against women and minor girls in Delhi and the NCR. The cases included the alleged gangrape of a 17-year-old girl at Aastha Kunj Park, the gangrape and murder of a teenage girl in Swaroop Nagar, and the sexual assault of a minor inside a moving sleeper bus that travelled more than 47 km from Greater Noida to Delhi without being intercepted.

The bench said it would pass a detailed order and posted the matter for further hearing on November 16.

India, Switzerland

visiting Rajghat to pay tribute to Mahatma Gandhi. External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar also met him ahead of his talks with Modi.

The agreements signed during the visit include a migration and mobility partnership pact, an arrangement for the exchange of young professionals and a major agreement covering cooperation in transportation technologies, mobility systems and infrastructure development. The migration pact seeks to facilitate movement between the two countries under equal treatment principles while addressing irregular migration and human trafficking in accordance with national laws.

The agreement provides for multiple-entry visas of up to five years, with stays of up to six months on each visit, as well as renewable one-year permits for students. The young professionals programme will allow 300 people from each country annually to undertake temporary employment to develop professional and language skills, with the number potentially rising to 500.

Modi said the two countries had also agreed on steps to expand market access for Indian exports to Switzerland and facilitate greater investment. He said the measures would support exports of agriculture, pharmaceuticals, textiles and engineering goods, while encouraging Swiss investment in biotechnology, life sciences, banking, insurance, food processing and sustainability.

The bilateral economic relationship has gained momentum since the Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement between India and the European Free Trade Association, comprising Switzerland, Iceland, Liechtenstein and Norway, came into force in October last year. The agreement was signed in March 2024 after nearly 16 years of negotiations.

Modi described the pact as an "ambitious blueprint" for investment, innovation, jobs and shared prosperity. "Through this, we will realise our goals of USD100 billion in investment and one million direct jobs in India over the next 15 years," he said.

Parmelin said the TEPA had created benefits for both countries, with India gaining access to capital, technology transfers and markets for high-value goods, while Switzerland gained access to a large and growing economy. He said Switzerland hoped to conclude an investment protection agreement with India soon and also pointed to the need for progress on intellectual property protection.

More than 330 Swiss companies currently operate in India in sectors including engineering, services, precision instruments, chemicals and pharmaceuticals. Indian companies have a presence in Switzerland in areas such as information technology, pharmaceuticals and machinery.

Infrastructure emerged as another area of expanding cooperation. Modi cited the ropeway in Varanasi, Jewar Airport in Noida, and railway and tunnelling projects in hilly regions as examples of existing collaboration. He invited Swiss infrastructure companies to invest in India and participate in capacity building, design and manufacturing.

The two sides also agreed to deepen cooperation in nuclear energy and explore new possibilities in military exchanges and defence production. Modi said science and technology would remain a major part of the partnership, with new joint research projects planned in health, clean energy and space.

Artificial intelligence was also discussed, with Parmelin saying the two countries were looking at governance that is innovative and equitable. Modi congratulated Switzerland on hosting the Geneva AI Summit next year after India hosted the global AI Summit in February.

On international issues, Modi said India and Switzerland shared support for democratic values, the rule of law, dialogue and diplomacy. "Whether in Ukraine or West Asia, India has supported every meaningful effort towards peace," he said.

The India-EFTA Prosperity Summit, scheduled for Wednesday, is expected to provide another platform for discussions on investment and trade. Parmelin, who is travelling with a large delegation of Swiss business leaders, will also meet President Droupadi Murmu, who will host an official banquet in his honour.

SC refuses

He raised concerns over multiple proceedings concerning the same project.

"Somebody comes and files a petition years later, and then three different petitions try to challenge it in three different ways," Venkataramani told the bench. He sought an opportunity for the Centre to make further submissions on the issue, saying, "I just want to keep the door open; nothing else."

Additional Solicitor General Aishwarya Bhati said proceedings before the NGT over the environmental clearance had already gone through two rounds. Senior advocate S Muralidhar, representing an impleaded tribal council, said the case involved Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups and that a PIL was therefore maintainable.

Justice Bagchi said questions over the scope of the public interest could remain open, while noting that the case also raised concerns about the constitutional protection of indigenous identity and culture. "Preservation of culture is a constitutionally protected fundamental right," he said.

The Supreme Court asked the High Court to complete pleadings in the connected matters and make efforts to hear them together on the scheduled dates.

The Calcutta High Court had on May 6 upheld the maintainability of the PILs, rejecting the Centre's objection that petitioner and former bureaucrat Meena Gupta lacked locus standi because she lived in Hyderabad.

The petitions allege violations of the 2006 Forest Rights Act and changes to eco-sensitive buffer zones around national parks as part of the Great Nicobar project.

Jaishankar

tariff volatility and economic uncertainty, but said India was confident of meeting the challenges.

"We know that this is going to be an age of flux... turbulent and volatile, with uncertainties," Jaishankar said during an interaction with former Singapore foreign minister George Yong Boon Yeo. He referred to the conflicts in Ukraine and the Gulf, tensions elsewhere and pressures from non-market factors and tariffs as signs of the "choppy waters" ahead.

Jaishankar said India had previously dealt with major disruptions, including Covid and simultaneous conflicts, as well as challenges involving energy, food and fertilisers. "We need to factor them into our thinking, plan and respond," he said, adding, "I'm very confident that we will rise to the challenge."

Turning to multilateral institutions, Jaishankar said the UN was "gridlocked" and had played little role in decision-making on several major global crises. He said the organisation had grown from 51 members to nearly four times that number, making changes to its structure necessary. "If you have grown four times and you want to keep the old board of management, it is not going to work. It is common sense," he said.

Jaishankar said some countries were resisting UN reform, including by invoking Africa's position, although African countries had already presented their demands during intergovernmental negotiations.

He said India supported fixing rather than abandoning the UN. "Our job must be to fix the UN, not to work around the UN," he said. Jaishankar also said the Global South expected India to articulate its concerns internationally and reiterated that dialogue and diplomacy remained the way forward on the Russia-Ukraine conflict.

SC gets 3 new judges

Justice Venkita Subramani Mohana, who was appointed on June 2, 2026.

While Justice Agarwal and Justice Nagarathna have a background of serving in high courts, Justice Mohana was elevated directly from the Bar. She had been a senior advocate of the Supreme Court.

Justice Nagarathna will also become the Chief Justice of India for more than a month in 2027.

Of the three judges appointed on Monday, Justices Agarwal and Upadhyay are originally from the Allahabad High Court, while Justice Singh originally belongs to the Jharkhand HC.

Nobel Medicine Prize

Press in a phone call an hour after the announcement.

He said the next task on his to-do list was to pack school lunches for his children, who were still sound asleep.

"That's my one obligation I have in the next few hours, to make sure I make their sandwiches," he said. Thomas Perlmann, the secretary of the medicine committee, said he was able to reach all three winners Monday. The AP's efforts to reach Hegemann and Nagel were not immediately successful.

The prize was announced at the Karolinska Institute in Stockholm, kicking off Nobels week. The prize money this year is 12 million Swedish kronor (about USD 1.2 million).

Last year, the prize went to three scientists researching the immune system.

Monday's medicine prize is followed by the physics prize on Tuesday, chemistry on Wednesday and literature on Thursday.

After Friday's peace prize is awarded, the Nobel Memorial Prize in Economic Sciences will be announced on Oct 12.

The prize money this year is 12 million Swedish kronor (about USD 1.2 million), whether for an individual, a small group of laureates or an organisation.

India-US trade

"Tariff was an instrument of negotiation, and tariff had a certain framework within which you would apply it. Today, the framework is there, but tariffs are going," she said, describing tariffs as increasingly "weaponised". Sitharaman also cited India's trade deficit with China, which she said had grown exponentially since 2014, and questioned how far countries could go beyond negotiations to correct such imbalances.

Her comments came days after US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer said Washington and New Delhi were working to finalise a bilateral trade agreement, but that a deal was not imminent. He also indicated that US President Donald Trump and Prime Minister Narendra Modi could speak again soon to review progress.

On the India-EU trade agreement, Sitharaman described it as an example of India's approach to negotiating trade pacts. She said the agreement would cover economies representing about two billion people and a significant share of global trade and GDP, while protecting national interests in a difficult global trading environment.

GST Council

The GST Council, chaired by Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman and comprising state ministers, will, in its meeting on Thursday, discuss changes in registration, returns, and refunds mechanism. It would also discuss policy reforms to resolve GST disputes and improve the flow of input tax credit, with the aim of reducing the time and cost of compliance.

According to sources, the GST Council is likely to consider sweeping process reforms to decriminalise GST offences, remove arrest powers of GST officers and make tax compliance easier for businesses, including e-commerce suppliers.

This is the second time that the date of the 57th GST Council meeting has been rescheduled.

The meeting, which was originally scheduled for September 12, was rescheduled to October 7 on account of the BRICS summit. India hosted the annual BRICS summit in New Delhi on September 12 and 13.

SC seeks plan

library, which has more than 8.5 lakh books. The library has been housed in Shastri Bhavan since 1969, but the building is proposed to be demolished.

Additional Solicitor General Aishwarya Bhati told the court that the library currently occupies 4,144 square metres and that around 5,200 square metres across two floors was being planned at a new location.

The bench sought details of the proposed space and questioned whether it would also accommodate nearly two lakh books stored in cartons at R K Puram, which have reportedly remained unopened since 2011.

"It is better that you file a proper affidavit," the bench said, directing the Centre to submit the actual layout and full details of the proposed premises.

The Centre has said space for the library has been provided in Kartavya Bhawan-2 and that construction-related processes are underway.

The matter will be heard next on November 16.

British Airways flight

local time and was scheduled to reach Chicago O'Hare International Airport after a flight of about eight hours and 40 minutes. About an hour into the journey, the aircraft had climbed to 37,000 feet when it appeared to encounter a technical problem and squawked the international aviation signal for a general emergency.

The aircraft then began a rapid descent, dropping to about 9,000 feet from 37,000 feet, a fall of roughly 28,000 feet, within minutes, flight-tracking data showed. It subsequently turned back towards the UK and landed safely at Heathrow.

British Airways said the aircraft returned to Heathrow because of a "technical issue" and that all passengers disembarked normally. "The safety of our customers and crew is always our top priority, and the aircraft landed safely after our highly-trained pilots returned to Heathrow following a technical issue," a BA spokesperson said.

"Customers disembarked the aircraft normally and our teams are working to get their travel plans back on track as quickly as possible," the spokesperson added.

The airline did not provide further details about the technical issue. The aircraft had been flying over Ireland when the emergency and rapid descent occurred.

Briefs

Rahul likely to visit Pune

PUNE: Opposition leader Rahul Gandhi is likely to meet students and aspirants protesting in Pune for reforms in Maharashtra Public Service Commission on October 7 or 8, NCP (SP) MLA Rohit Pawar has said.

Demonstrations are being held at three locations in Pune with disparate demands, including an objective or descriptive format of MPSC examinations. However, the main demand is the resignation of MPSC chairman Vivek Bhimanwar amid allegations of paper leaks.

Stage set for Nagaon bypoll battle

NAGAON: The stage is set for a triangular contest in the Nagaon Lok Sabha bypoll in Assam on Tuesday, with the ruling BJP seeking to expand its base in this Muslim-majority constituency, and the Congress going all out to retain the seat by keeping its minority support base intact.

The AIUDF, the third prominent party in the fray, is fighting to maintain its influence after it was decimated to two MLAs from 16 in the April Assembly election.

Shinde meets Modi in Delhi

MUMBAI: Maharashtra Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde met PM Narendra Modi on Monday, during which the latter assured the Centre's support in tackling the drought.

Speaking to reporters, Shinde said Modi held an extensive discussion on the drought situation in Maharashtra.

Tripura: One dies in stampede

AGARTALA: Tripura Chief Minister Manik Saha on Monday said a person died in a stampede after security forces baton-charged a mob outside a counting centre for village committee polls in Khowai district.

The incident occurred outside the counting centre in Champahower area when a large number of workers of several political parties gathered there to know the poll results and unrest ensued, prompting the security personnel to take action, officer said.

Ukd: Harish Rawat holds march

DEHRADUN: Despite a directive from the Congress high command against organising 'parallel programs' within the party, senior leader Harish Rawat launched a march and public outreach program on Monday in Udham Singh Nagar district.

During the "Dhanyavad evam Jansamvad Yatra", Rawat said his objective is to work towards ousting the BJP govts from both Uttarakhand and UP.

'GYANESH KUMAR BETRAYED CONSTITUTION'

Citing SC's assertion on Form 6, Oppn seeks resignation of CEC

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 5

Stepping up their attack on CEC Gyanesh Kumar after the Supreme Court said it had not approved any modifications to Form 6, the Congress and other Opposition parties demanded his immediate resignation, alleging that he betrayed the Constitution at the behest of the Prime Minister and Home minister and unilaterally made changes to the form for the SIR process.

The BJP, however, said the Supreme Court notices to the EC and the Centre are "proof" that all institutions in the country are "functioning independently" and democratically and there is no atmosphere of "fear and dictatorship".

Law minister Arjun Ram Meghwal also defended the SIR exercise, saying an accurate and updated voter list is the bedrock of a transparent and fair election process.

Opposition parties including Congress, CPI, AAP and BJD demanded that Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Kumar must resign immediately after the Supreme Court issued notices to the Election Commission and the Centre on pleas alleging that the poll body took several decisions during the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of polls without the approval of two other election commissioners.



CEC Gyanesh Kumar PTI

KEY POINTS

- The developments came a day ahead of the proposed march by Opposition MPs from Parliament House to the Election Commission's office over the SIR row and 'vote chori' charge
- Form 6 is an application through which an eligible person seeks inclusion in the electoral rolls

The developments came a day ahead of the proposed march by Opposition MPs from Parliament House to the Election Commission's office over the SIR row and "vote chori" charge.

A bench of Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana said, "We will examine all the decisions. If any decision is not in accordance with the law, we will annul it. You know the power of the court."

The bench said that "any modification to Form 6 has not been approved by us. Let's be clear. When records are produced, we would like to see who has modified it".

Form 6 is an application through which an eligible person seeks inclusion in the electoral rolls.

Leading the attack, Rahul Gandhi said it is now established beyond doubt that CEC Gyanesh Kumar changed Form 6 "illegally and unilaterally".

"It is now established beyond doubt that Gyanesh Kumar changed Form 6 illegally and unilaterally. This is just one more proof of him abusing his position to help the BJP."

"He and everyone else involved in this criminal assault on our democracy will be held accountable," the Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha said in a post on X.

Congress chief Mallikarjun Kharge said his party has three "non-negotiable demands" - resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, annulment of SIR and conduct of elections on ballot paper instead of EVMs.

Congress general secretary (in-charge communications) Jairam Ramesh also lashed out at the CEC, saying the CEC "lied".

"Form 6 was deliberately modified by the CEC himself to delete Gen Z voters of whom the PM is simply terrified," Ramesh alleged on X.

This "malicious" Form 6 modification, which was originally implied to have the Supreme Court's approval, is one such example of his underhanded and simply indefensible conduct, he said.

"In reality, the CEC has not only lied but also violated the law and betrayed the Constitution in letter and spirit at the behest of the PM and the HM," Ramesh alleged.

Cong announces 'Vote Bachao, Desh Bachao' campaign

'Will reach out to 13.3 crore deleted voters of country'

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 5

The Congress on Monday announced a sustained nationwide agitation against the SIR exercise and Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar, including a programme under which its workers, called "vote rakshaks", will reach out to the more than 13.3 crore people whose names have been struck off the voters' list.

The announcement for a "Vote Bachao, Desh Bachao" campaign was made after Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge chaired a meeting of party general secretaries, in-charges and state unit chiefs at the Indira Bhawan here. Former Congress president Rahul Gandhi was also present at the meeting.

Briefing reporters on the meeting, Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh said all INDIA Bloc MPs will peacefully march from the Makar Dwar of Parliament House to the Election Commission's (EC) office on Tuesday morning.

From October 2 to October 8, the parties in the Opposition Bloc will have district-level meetings and marches against "vote chori" (vote theft), pressing for the demand of Kumar's removal, he said.

From October 10 to October 20, the Congress in particular, would carry out these marches and meetings as part of the campaign.



Congress MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra during a meeting with party General Secretaries, state In-charges, and state presidents, in New Delhi PTI

Mayawati's nephew Akash back in BSP

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Lucknow, October 5

THIS WAS THE THIRD TIME THAT THE BSP CHIEF HAD "REMOVED" HER NEPHEW FROM THE PARTY

Bahujan Samaj Party supremo Mayawati on Monday announced the reappointment of Akash Anand as the party's national convenor, saying the decision was taken in the interest of the party and the movement.

"After considerable thought, the party has decided, in the interest of the party and the movement, to once again appoint Akash Anand as the BSP's national convenor and give him an opportunity to work in the party again," Mayawati said in a post on X.

On September 10, Mayawati had announced the ouster of Anand, setting him "completely free" from BSP.

On September 3, she had removed him from the crucial post of national convenor of the party. Mayawati had said Akash prioritised his family and personal interests over the party.

This was the third time that the BSP chief had "removed" her nephew from the party.

Why you & your police afraid of women, Rahul questions Shah

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 5

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Monday alleged that a pattern of silencing women who dare to ask questions was being observed in Delhi and demanded justice for all those who have faced violence and misbehaviour at the hands of the Delhi Police.

Gandhi made the remarks in a post accompanying a video of his recent interaction with two journalists, Shaheen Khan and Nafisa Khan, who were allegedly assaulted at the Saket police station after they went to cover the inauguration of a new wing at Max Hospital in Saket by Union Home minister Amit Shah and Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta.

"What's happening in Delhi right now follows a single pattern: silence any woman who dares to ask questions," Gandhi said in his post in Hindi on X.

"Hundreds of people were detained at Jantar Mantar. Female protesters alleged that male police officers misbehaved with them. Cameras were snatched from female journalists, and they were dragged around. Not even an FIR was filed on a journalist's complaint," the Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha said.

A few weeks ago, Shaheen and Nafisa recounted their experiences of violence and mistreatment inside the Saket police station, he said.

"Think about it -- inside the station, the very place where women go to file complaints," the former Congress chief said.

Those entrusted with the responsibility of protecting women were now the ones posing a threat to them, Gandhi said.

Chennai: PM to inaugurate Metro rail project on Oct 11

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Chennai, October 5

Prime Minister Narendra Modi will visit Chennai on October 11 to dedicate a Metro rail project to the public and participate in other official programmes, senior BJP leader Pon Radhakrishnan confirmed on Monday.

Modi is scheduled to inaugurate the 14.6-km Poonamallee-Vadapalani stretch of the Chennai Metro's Phase II project and take a train ride from Poonamallee to Porur, according to party sources.

Radhakrishnan was speaking at an event organised at Kamalalayam, the BJP state headquarters here to welcome Tamil Nadu BJP in-charge Ram Madhav and co-incharges. The newly appointed members had come to meet BJP state president Nainar Nagendran.

CJP says Oct 10 protest 'call of youth', welcomes INDIA Bloc stir

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 5

The Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) on Monday sought to play down its recent sparring with sections of the Congress, welcoming the INDIA Bloc's proposed protest on Tuesday and saying its own October 10 mobilisation should be seen as a broader call by the youth rather than that of a particular organisation.

CJP co-convener Saurav Das said everyone -- political parties, student organisations, activists and common people -- should assert their rights through peaceful protests.

"We welcome all peaceful protests. Everyone should make efforts, be it INDIA Bloc or other student organisations or activists, or common people. Everyone needs to assert their rights," Das told a press conference, referring to the INDIA Bloc's planned protest against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar on Tuesday.



CJP national spokesperson Saurabh Das addresses a press conference, in New Delhi, Monday PTI

"EVERYONE -- POLITICAL PARTIES, STUDENT ORGANISATIONS, ACTIVISTS AND COMMON PEOPLE -- SHOULD ASSERT THEIR RIGHTS THROUGH PEACEFUL PROTESTS

On the October 10 mobilisation plan of the CJP, Das said, "You should not consider the call for protests on October 10 as our call or someone else's call. This is the call by the youth and Gen Z. We are one part of that."

The remarks come against the backdrop of an over-the-weekend online spat between CJP and sections aligned with the Congress, after a social media post compared CJP national convener Abhijeet Dipke with AISA president Neha Bora.

While Dipke and Bora themselves rejected any rivalry, CJP leaders accused sections of the "liberal ecosystem" of seeking to undermine Dipke.

All lined up for polling in TN for high stakes by-election

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Chennai, October 5

Preparations are complete for the polling exercise to be held on October 6 for byelections to Madurantakam and Dharapuram Assembly Constituencies and the Tamil Nadu voters are poised to decide the fortunes of the fledgling TVK regime which hinges on outside support for its survival.

The hectic campaign by Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay, DMK President MK Stalin, Leader of Opposition Udhyanidhi Stalin and AIADMK supremo Edappadi K Palaniswami, not seen often during run up to the bypolls, has only underscored the political significance as results are pretty crucial for both the ruling and Opposition camps.

For the TVK, the poll outcome will decide if it can shore-up its strength in the Assembly or not, and as regards the DMK, which did not expect to lose the April Assembly polls, it will be crucial to bounce back.

The bypolls face a tough five-corner fight as the ruling TVK, main Opposition DMK, key Dravidian party AIADMK, the Left Front, and Tamil nationalist TVK are in the fray.

Opposition's allegation that the byelections are not a natural outcome but something forced on the people due to "horse-trading" is a core issue that echoed during campaigning.

The TVK, however, has repeatedly rejected the claim, maintaining that the AIADMK MLAs quit the party and joined it following frustration over attempts by Edappadi Palaniswami camp to join forces with "evil force" DMK in order to form a government.

JEE-ADVANCED 2026

Women qualification rate highest in 6 yrs, crosses 10K mark

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi 18 March

Women candidates achieved the highest success rate in the IIT JEE-Advanced entrance exam in 2026, with the number of qualifying candidates crossing the 10,000 mark for the first time in the last six years, according to official data.

The Joint Implementation Committee (JIC) report for 2026 by the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Roorkee, which conducted the Joint Entrance Examination (JEE) Advanced this year, noted that the qualification rate among registered women candidates rose to 23.4 per cent this year, compared to 21.7 per cent last year.

Of the 43,112 women registered for JEE Advanced 2026, 40,562 appeared in both papers while 10,107 qualified, crossing the 10,000-mark for the first time. One in four registered women candidates qualified this year, compared with roughly one in five last year.

"In 2026, 3,814 female-only seats (including female supernumerary seats) were allotted, and 37 female candidates secured seats through the gender-neutral pool," the report said.

The qualification rate for Scheduled Caste (SC) and Scheduled Tribe (ST) candidates also rose sharply by 9.8 and 8.1 percentage points, respectively, since last year.

A total of 15,856 SC candidates and 6,379 ST candidates qualified in 2026, compared to 12,499 and 5,008, respectively, in 2025. The top 2.5 lakh candidates in JEE (Main) are eligible to appear for JEE (Advanced).

A total of 1,79,694 candidates appeared in both papers 1 and 2 in JEE (Advanced) 2026, held on May 17. The result was declared on June 1, with 56,880 candidates qualifying.

"The qualifying criteria were relaxed to ensure at least twice the number of candidates qualify as compared to available seats in each category," the report said.

Compiled annually by the organising IIT, the JIC report provides critical transparency regarding seating matrices, branch allocation shifts and statistical summaries of student performances.

The number of general category qualifiers fell from 16,154 in 2025 to 15,883 this year, with the qualification rate declining from 43 per cent to 39.8 per cent. The Economically Weaker Section (EWS) qualifiers rose from 6,291 to 6,377.

For OBC-NCL candidates, the qualification rate declined from 18.2 per cent to 17.5 per cent, while the number of qualifiers fell from 12,606 to 12,385.

CLOSER LOOK

- The top 2.5 lakh candidates in JEE (Main) are eligible to appear for JEE (Advanced)
- A total of 1,79,694 candidates appeared in both papers 1 and 2 in JEE (Advanced) 2026, held on May 17

ALSO DIRECTS TO IDENTIFY AN AUTHORITY

Pick five cities for footpath pilot project: SC to Centre

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 5



The Supreme Court on Monday asked the Centre to identify five cities across the country for starting a pilot project to ensure properly demarcated and encroachment-free footpaths wherever there is a road.

A bench of Justices P S Narasimha and Alok Aradhe also directed the Centre to identify an authority that would be responsible for implementing the directions.

In a significant verdict delivered on June 19, the top court had held that the right to walk on a demarcated footpath is a fundamental right.

During the hearing on Monday, the bench told Additional Solicitor General K M Nataraj, who appeared for the Centre, that the authority that would be responsible for ensuring a footpath wherever there is a road should have the requisite space, funds, infrastructure and manpower to do the work entrusted to it.

"Which will be that centralised authority, you tell us. The authority should have the funds, staff (and) infrastructure. Secondly, tell us about five cities where you can have the pilot project," the bench told the law officer.

Nataraj said he would apprise the bench about it.

"We direct the Union of India to identify an authority which would be responsible for implementing the need for establishing footpaths," the bench said.

"We are also of the opinion that five towns could be identified where we can start a pilot project of provisioning footpaths wherever roads exist," it said.

The bench posted the matter for hearing after three weeks.

While hearing the matter on August 24, the top court had said that the existence of footpaths was an integral part of human life.

It had directed all the states and Union territories to respond on the implementation of its directions for properly demarcated, encroachment-free spaces for pedestrians.

The top court is dealing with a case on ensuring properly demarcated footpaths wherever there is a road.

The apex court had earlier said that a citizen's fundamental right to walk on a demarcated footpath is primary and shall have priority over movement by motorised vehicles.

The declaration by the court came in an unfortunate motor accident compensation case, in which a man lost his five-year-old son while taking him to school.

"The right to walk is a fundamental right under Part III of the Constitution. It is integral to the right to movement guaranteed under Article 19(1)(d), read with Article 19(1)(a), Article 19(1) (b), Article 19(1) (c) and Article 21 of the Constitution of India. The fundamental right to walk will take within its sweep the right to demarcated footpaths. These rights are primary and shall have priority over movement by motorised vehicles," it had ruled.

It had held that the fundamental right to walk on demarcated footpaths has a correlative duty and "if the road exists, there is a duty to ensure that there are demarcated and well-maintained footpaths for walkers".

It had directed the top court registry to register a case titled "In Re: Fundamental Right to Walk and Footpath" and impleaded the Centre through the ministries of Housing and Urban Affairs, Rural Development, and Road Transport and Highways as parties in the matter.

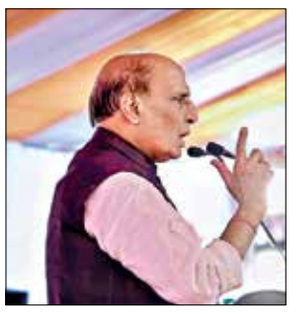
TAKEAWAYS

- In a significant verdict delivered on June 19, the top court had held that the right to walk on a demarcated footpath is a fundamental right
- The top court is dealing with a case on ensuring properly demarcated footpaths wherever there is a road
- The bench posted the matter for hearing after three weeks

SINGH BATS FOR VEDIC MATHS

Rajnath says students should understand both shlokas as well as computer code

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Ayodhya, October 5



Rajnath Singh during the 'Sri Guru Praj Mahamahotsav' and 'Sant Sammelan', in Ayodhya PTI

SINGH SAID TRADITIONAL KNOWLEDGE SHOULD BE CONNECTED WITH CONTEMPORARY REQUIREMENTS RATHER THAN BEING CONFINED TO THE PAST

Defence minister Rajnath Singh on Monday said Sanskrit and Vedic mathematics were relevant in modern education, asserting that students should be equipped to understand both ancient Sanskrit shlokas and modern computer code.

Addressing a Sant Sammelan organised on the occasion of the Shri Guru Parv Mahamahotsav here, Singh said Sanskrit was not merely a language but a "repository of India's knowledge tradition", encompassing subjects ranging from the Vedas and Upanishads to mathematics, medicine, philosophy and literature.

"We need students who understand Sanskrit shlokas as well as computer code," Singh said, adding that traditional knowledge should be connected with contemporary requirements rather than being confined to the past.

Singh also highlighted the importance of Vedic mathematics, recalling that he had introduced it when he was the Uttar Pradesh education minister in 1991.

Describing it as a language of India's intellectual heritage, he said he would urge Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath to ensure that Vedic mathematics was taught to students in the state if he returns to power.

"I was a student of physics, mathematics and chemistry, and I can say that Vedic mathematics is still unparalleled. Even very difficult mathematical problems can be solved through Vedic methods," he said, further claiming that it was also taught at the London School of Economics.

The defence minister was speaking at the newly constructed building of Shri Narayan Sanskrit Mahavidyalaya at the Shri Udasin Sangat Rishi Ashram in Ayodhya.

Chief Minister Adityanath was scheduled to attend the programme but could not reach the venue due to other engagements, Singh said.

The minister also clarified that he did not formally inaugurate the newly constructed building as the Model Code of Conduct (MLA polls) was in force. "But I did inspect the building," he said.

J&K: 10.39L e-challans issued in 2026

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Srinagar, October 5

Enforcement agencies in Jammu and Kashmir have issued 10.39 lakh e-challans during the current year, marking a significant shift towards technology-enabled traffic management and reducing dependence on manual checks, an official said here on Monday.

This information was given at a high-level meeting chaired by Chief Secretary Atal Dulloo to take comprehensive stock of the Road Safety Action Plan, accident data, i-RAD, black spot rectification, trauma care, digital enforcement and other road safety interventions across the Union Territory.

"To extend technology-based traffic management to rural areas, a detailed project report for Rural Intelligent Traffic Management System (ITMS) has been prepared, covering 2,144 digital devices across 25 critical corridors and 195 rural junctions," an official spokesperson said.

The chief secretary directed all the executing agencies to accord top priority to the time-bound rectification of identified black spots and hazardous stretches, stressing that every identified engineering deficiency should be addressed through short- and long-term corrective measures.

Dulloo called upon all District Road Safety Committees, chaired by the respective District Magistrates, to meet mandatorily every month, closely monitor the i-RAD real-time accident dashboards and ensure prompt rectification of residual infrastructure hazards.

Punjab Cabinet approves new driver posts in office of CEO

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, October 5

The Punjab Cabinet on Monday gave its nod to the Ranjitgarh Development Authority (RDA) Bill, 2026. The decision was taken at a meeting of the Council of Ministers held here under the chairmanship of Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann.

Sharing this, the Chief Minister's Office stated the Ranjitgarh Development Authority Bill, 2026 would provide for the establishment of the Ranjitgarh Development Authority (RDA) for planned, sustainable and eco-tourism-oriented development of the Ranjit Sagar Dam and Shahpur Kandi Dam areas.

The RDA will be constituted as a statutory body under the administrative control of the Department of Tourism and Cultural Affairs and will be vested with requisite administrative, financial and regulatory powers for integrated development, land management, project implementation and destination governance.

The Authority will be chaired by CM Mann, with the Minister of Tourism and Cultural Affairs as Vice-Chairman.

An Executive Committee headed by the Chief Secretary will oversee its day-to-day functioning and interdepartmental coordination.

The Cabinet also gave approval for the creation of new posts of Drivers in the office of the Chief Electoral Officer, Punjab.

Briefs

Elderly man killed by tiger in MP

SEONI: A tiger mauled a 63-year-old man to death while he was grazing cattle in Seoni district of Madhya Pradesh on Monday, an official said.

The incident took place in the revenue area adjoining compartment P-358 of Pindrai beat in Kurai range, he added.

Punjab: 4 killed as bus overturns

CHANDIGARH: A bus overturned in Punjab's Shaheed Bhagat Singh Nagar district on Monday, leaving four people, including a student, dead and 17 injured, police said.

The bus was en route from Manali to Amritsar when the accident occurred after the driver apparently lost control over the vehicle, a police official from the district said.

Baze engulfs firecracker godown, 2 die

HINGOLI : Two people were killed and seven others were injured in a massive fire and explosions in a godown of firecrackers in Hingoli district on Monday night, an official said.

The incident occurred at 8 pm in Marwadi Galli, a densely populated residential area, he added.

Ayush services sector supports about 1.76 million livelihoods

Women constitute 43% of workforce

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 5

The Ayush services sector supports an estimated 1.76 million livelihoods in India, with women accounting for 43 per cent of its workforce, according to a recent assessment that highlights the sector's growing role in employment generation and economic growth.

The assessment, Ayush Service Sector Report by Research and Information System for Developing Countries (RIS), released recently on Ayurveda Day 2026, said women's representation exceeds 50 per cent in several organised segments, including hospitals, day-care centres, educational institutes and wellness establishments.

Women account for more than 60 per cent of the workforce in spas and wellness resorts, 58 per cent in educational institutes, 57 per cent in day-care centres and 53 per cent in hospitals, it said.

"The growing Ayush services sector is creating meaningful employment opportunities across healthcare, wellness, education and allied services. Its expansion is not only strengthening India's healthcare ecosystem but also opening new avenues for entrepreneurship, skill development and women's participation in the workforce," Union Ayush Minister Prataprao Jadhav said.

According to the report, more than one million livelihoods are concentrated in local and standalone clinics, demonstrating the sector's extensive employment footprint across urban and rural areas.

NFR organises Sukna Station Mahotsav



OUR CORRESPONDENT
Maligaon, October 5

Northeast Frontier Railway (NFR) organised the Sukna Station Mahotsav on October 3, 2026, to celebrate 146 years of the architectural heritage buildings of the Darjeeling Himalayan Railway (DHR), a UNESCO World Heritage Site.

The programme was graced by the General Manager of NFR, Shri Chetan Kumar Shrivastava and several senior railway officials and distinguished dignitaries, highlighting the railway's commitment towards preserving its historic assets and promoting community participation.

Haryana CM Saini participates in SING Forum in Singapore

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, October 5



Chief Minister Nayab Saini with Singapore Minister of State Gan Siow Huang, in Singapore

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini participated in a programme organised under the SING (Singapore India Network for Growth) Forum on the second day of his Singapore visit.

Prominent Singaporean industrialists, distinguished representatives from various sectors and Chhattisgarh Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai were also present at the programme. The key objective of the programme was to discuss various aspects of mutual cooperation between Haryana and Singapore, besides promoting infrastructure and industries in Haryana in the future.

The Chief Minister said that his goal is not only to establish Haryana as an industrial powerhouse but also as India's Innovation Capital.

Addressing senior representatives of the industry, Chief Minister Saini said that today's platform is not merely a forum for discussions on investment or business. It is a platform to further strengthen trust, friendship and cooperation between two countries and two economies.

Referring to the depth of India-Singapore relations, the CM said that the relationship between the two countries is not limited to trade and investment. It is built on trust, friendship, culture and strong people-to-people ties.

At present, the relationship is at the level of a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership, but the real strength of any partnership lies not merely in agreements, but in people-to-people relations, partnerships between businesses and results on the ground.

Massive pricing disparity uncovered in UP hospital pharmacies

Medicine procured for Rs 74.09 is being sold with a maximum retail price of Rs 4,980.94 in Uttar Pradesh

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Lucknow, October 5

A medicine procured for Rs 74.09 is being sold with a maximum retail price of Rs 4,980.94 in Uttar Pradesh—a 67-fold gap between its purchase cost and printed price.

Polymyxin-B injection, used to treat serious bacterial infections, was among 36 of 130 medicines identified by the Uttar Pradesh Food Safety and Drug Administration (FSDA) whose MRPs exceeded their purchase prices by more than 10 times.

The findings followed an FSDA examination of 214 pharmacies in medical colleges and private hospitals across the state. The department found the widest disparities among injectable drugs used in intensive care and other critical conditions.

The Polymyxin-B case was the most striking. The injection was procured for Rs 74.09 but carried an MRP of Rs 4,980.94. Another injection used to treat serious liver disease was purchased for Rs 56 and had an MRP of Rs 3,050—more than 54 times the purchase price.

Large gaps were also found in medicines for severe bacterial and fungal infections. Meropenem 1 gram, used for serious bacterial infections, showed significant brand variation, with MRPs ranging from 5.31 to 9.98 times their respective purchase prices.

Caspofungin 70 mg, used to treat fungal infections, was purchased for Rs 800 but carried an MRP of Rs 21,230—about 26.5 times the procurement cost. Another brand was purchased for Rs 897.75 and had an MRP of Rs 19,892.

The analysis also found substantial price differences in medicines used for cancer treatment and other life-saving conditions, raising concerns for patients undergoing serious or prolonged treatment, when comparing prices or seeking alternatives is difficult.

The FSDA said unusually high MRPs may allow substantial trade margins and discounts.

A high printed price can create room for discounts while preserving sizeable margins across the supply chain.

Medical devices sold through hospital pharmacies showed similar disparities. A three-way stopcock was purchased for Rs 6.40 but carried an MRP of Rs 163—nearly 25 times the purchase price. Another device was procured for Rs 20.95 and had an MRP of Rs 500, nearly 24 times the purchase cost.

The issue is more serious in private hospitals where some medicines are available only through the hospital pharmacy. Described in the departmental assessment as monopoly medicines, these products may not be readily available in the open market. During emergencies, intensive care or treatment for serious illnesses, patients and their families have little opportunity to compare prices or seek cheaper alternatives, potentially increasing the final treatment bill.

The FSDA findings do not mean the entire difference between a medicine's procurement price and MRP represents profit for a hospital or pharmacy.

HIGHLIGHTS

- Polymyxin-B injection, used to treat serious bacterial infections, was among 36 of 130 medicines identified by the Uttar Pradesh FSDA whose MRPs exceeded their purchase prices by more than 10 times
- Analysis also found substantial price differences in medicines used for cancer treatment and other life-saving conditionsRussia provides an interesting backdrop for this programme

EDITORIAL

Transparency Builds Trust

An electoral roll may look like an administrative register, a collection of names periodically corrected as citizens move, die or become eligible to vote. In a democracy, however, every inclusion and deletion carries constitutional weight. The integrity of the roll determines who gets to participate in choosing a government. That is why the procedures governing it must command exceptional transparency and institutional care.

The latest controversy over Form 6, used for enrolling new voters, brings this principle into sharp focus. The Supreme Court has clarified that it did not approve modifications to the form and has indicated that it would examine the record concerning how the changes were made. Separately, questions have reached the Court over decision-making within the Election Commission. These proceedings should not prejudge the issues before the judiciary, but they underline why electoral administration cannot afford procedural ambiguity.

Rules governing voter registration are not bureaucratic inconveniences. They exist to ensure that decisions carrying consequences for a citizen's voting rights are made according to law. Administrative flexibility may be necessary while managing an electoral roll of enormous scale, but flexibility cannot create uncertainty over the source of authority. When a requirement affects enrolment, citizens should know who authorised it, under which provision and through what process.

The same principle applies with even greater force to deletion. Electoral rolls must undoubtedly be accurate. Names of the deceased, duplicate registrations and entries of people who are no longer ordinarily resident in a constituency have to be addressed. But accuracy cannot be pursued by treating inclusion and exclusion as routine clerical exercises. A roll that removes incorrect entries but also excludes legitimate voters cannot be considered credible merely because it has become cleaner on paper.

Due process is therefore indispensable. A citizen facing deletion should receive adequate notice, understandable reasons and a meaningful opportunity to establish eligibility. Equally, someone seeking inclusion should not encounter requirements whose legal basis or administrative origin is unclear. The burden of maintaining accurate rolls cannot be transferred entirely to citizens, particularly when documentation, migration and changes of residence can complicate verification.

The Election Commission consequently carries a demanding responsibility. Its constitutional independence protects electoral administration from political interference, but independence must coexist with institutional accountability. Important decisions should emerge through clearly established processes, with records capable of explaining how and why they were taken. Internal differences, where they arise, should be resolved within the statutory framework rather than leaving uncertainty about institutional authority.

Technology can make registration, verification and correction faster, but it cannot substitute for fairness. Digital databases can identify discrepancies; they cannot determine citizenship rights without lawful procedures and human scrutiny. Efficiency is valuable only when accompanied by safeguards against wrongful exclusion.

The electoral roll is ultimately where citizenship meets democratic participation. Protecting its integrity requires accuracy, but also legality, transparency and fairness. Every eligible citizen must have confidence that entry into or removal from the roll follows rules rather than discretion. In something as fundamental as determining who gets to vote, procedure is not a technicality. It is itself a democratic safeguard.

LETTER

letter2editor.mp@gmail.com.

Right to walk

The Supreme Court's push for encroachment-free footpaths is a welcome recognition that pedestrians deserve priority in urban planning. The five-city pilot must produce continuous, accessible and well-maintained walking spaces, not cosmetic stretches of pavement. Safe mobility should be treated as essential public infrastructure across Indian cities.

SREEMOYEE GHOSH,
KOLKATA

You can also send your comments to The Editor, *Millennium Post,* Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

History of a Perpetual Lease

Documents from the making of New Delhi showed that Gymkhana's perpetual lease was rooted in government policy, financing and institutional trust

ARCHIVAL LENS



RAGHAV CHANDRA

THE WRITER IS A FORMER SECRETARY TO THE GOI



The club paid the full premium for its 27.3-acre perpetual lease before execution

The government's decision to determine the perpetual lease of the Delhi Gymkhana Club and take back its 27.3 acres has arisen perhaps due to a distorted image of this club - as a decadent relic of the Raj, as a playground for colonial officials - to which independent India owes nothing. Archival records tell a radically different story.

It is a myth that Gymkhana was built for the British alone. Government (Finance Department) records state its purpose, from the very beginning, as serving "Europeans and Indians alike." Its Articles of Association imposed no bar on Indians. At a time when many clubs across the empire shut their doors to Indians, Gymkhana was open to them.

Gymkhana club wasn't another private commercial venture that got government land as a lucky deal. The New Capital Committee proposed the club at its present site in August 1926, with the government providing land on perpetual lease and a loan to build a clubhouse and residential quarters for officers.

The reasoning was practical. Officers on transferable postings needed continuity of comfort wherever they were sent, and the club was conceived as social infrastructure for them. That intent is written into the documents - the loan agreement required that "not less than 75% of the residential quarters" built with the loan be reserved for government servants who were members.

The perpetual lease itself records that the 27.3 acres, carved out of land acquired for the new capital, were given "under the instructions of the Government of India." A body whose construction the government financed, and pledged to complete, cannot credibly be recast as an interloper on public land.

Why, then, was the land leased rather than granted outright? It could have been given on free title, but for the Rs 5 lakh loan. The soft loan was approved first, and the land was conveyed through a perpetual lease so that the government's money stayed secured. The clause permitting determination was an enabling provision to safeguard the loan's return, not a weapon to be drawn a century later.

ARCHIVAL DOCUMENTS CHALLENGED THE IDEA OF GYMKHANA AS MERELY A COLONIAL-ERA PRIVATE CLUB

The loan agreement and lease mirror each other, linking the grant of land, the Rs 5 lakh loan and the obligation to construct the clubhouse within two years.

The documents were vetted by then Solicitor of India Sir T.E.T. Upton, who saw their congruence plainly. "The Lease must be executed before the Mortgage and should have a previous date," he cautioned. Loan and lease were thus one interlinked transaction, driven by the government.

This was never a landlord dealing with a private tenant pursuing a solitary commercial objective. It was a relationship of principal and agent: a government and an entity it brought into being for a social purpose, bound by mutual confidence, expectation and trust.

The terms on which land in the new capital was leased to social institutions were set by the Imperial Delhi Committee in instructions dated 24 December 1914, conveyed to the Department of Revenue and Agriculture and preserved in Home Department records. "The Committee was very strongly in favor of the granting of permanent leases," they record. Even terminable 80-year leases, it said, would not be summarily ended but renewed.

In theory, the Committee reasoned, government could resume a site or raise ground rent without limit when a lease fell in. That it would ever exercise those rights to the full was "out of the question," because "less than any other landlord can Government afford to earn the reputation of harsh and inequitable dealing." Its framers understood that without such confidence, nobody would make long-term investments in the land.

Gymkhana held a perpetual lease, a stronger tenure still, and it paid for it. The premium was fixed at Rs 200 an acre, the prevailing market rate, and the club paid the full Rs 5,460 for its 27.3 acres before the lease was signed. The lease acknowledges that premium as "paid before the execution of these presents." Having paid the capital value of the leasehold estate, the club became, with the government's blessing and as its agent, the owner of that estate. The transaction was contractually closed.

Gymkhana's heritage also lies in its role in the making of India's independence. Its first General Committee included senior government representatives, Indian princes and legal luminary Sir S.R. Das. Several rulers of princely states subsequently became members. The club became an informal meeting ground for the princes, which helped ease their subsequent integration into the Indian nation. The Gandhi-Irwin talks took place in Gymkhana, arranged by the Nawab of Bhopal. Lord Hardinge was a patron and visitor.

Government records describe Gymkhana as a provider of social and leisure activities. In over 100 years, it has not digressed from that charter.

Much of what stands today was built on goodwill. In 1935, Lady Willingdon, the Viceroy's wife, donated Rs 21,000 for the covered swimming pool and the squash courts, commemorated on a marble plaque as the Lady Willingdon Bath and the Willingdon Squash Courts.

Determining Gymkhana's lease is to turn a clause written only to secure a loan into an instrument of expropriation, and negate the principles the Imperial Delhi Committee decided - that government would never earn a reputation for harsh and inequitable dealing. It will also be a rejection of history and heritage.

Views expressed are personal

Bridging the Development Gap

The value of CSR lies beyond spending – in creating sustainable change on ground

SHARED PROGRESS



ASHOK KUMAR GUPTA

THE WRITER IS A FORMER IAS OFFICER AND CHAIRMAN, CCI

In the social sector, both government and Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) initiatives are driven by a shared objective–improving lives and enabling inclusive development. In that sense, they are not parallel efforts, but partners in progress.

Yet, the difference in scale is stark. CSR spending in India is approximately ₹40,000 crore, while combined government expenditure at the Centre and State levels is nearly ₹24 lakh crore–almost sixty times larger.

CSR is not defined by the size of its budget, but by the impact it creates. It is not a substitute for government effort–it is a strategic complement. In many ways, CSR serves as a bridge between policy intent and outcomes on the ground.

Scale vs Flexibility: The Macro and the Micro

Government systems bring scale, reach, and institutional strength. However, they are necessarily bound by procedures and frameworks. CSR, on the other hand, brings flexibility–the ability to respond to local realities and adapt quickly.

At DBF, for instance, work spans over 64,000 households across 12 locations with a clear goal: enhancing annual household income sustainably. Each household is mapped in detail–its assets, capabilities, and aspirations–and based on this, customized intervention plans are developed.

Importantly, income progression is tracked through digital tools, ensuring that interventions are measurable and outcomes are visible.

Bridging the Last Mile

Every year, governments introduce numerous schemes across agriculture, irrigation, livelihoods, and social welfare. The intent is strong and the architecture robust. Yet, the last mile often remains a challenge.

Eligible beneficiaries may remain unaware of schemes or struggle to navigate procedures.

This is where CSR creates tangible value. At DBF, where I serve as the CEO, teams work closely with communities and government departments to identify relevant schemes, facilitate enrollment, and go a step further–linking beneficiaries to formal credit systems.

An interaction with a bank branch manager in Kadapa offers a telling insight. She readily sanctions applications recommended by DBF, citing two reasons: thorough due diligence and strong post-loan support. Notably, repayment rates for DBF-supported cases stand at 99%, compared to a general rate of 97%.

It reflects not just financial discipline, but the sustainability of income generation. By maintaining close coordination with banks and monitoring repayment trends,



The last mile of development needs sustained engagement

THE REAL QUESTION IS NOT WHO DOES MORE, BUT WHO ENABLES BETTER OUTCOMES

CSR interventions strengthen both credibility and future access to credit–an area where government mechanisms often face limitations.

Convergence: The Multiplier Effect

One of the greatest strengths of CSR lies in its ability to enable convergence.

By aligning closely with government programs–whether through agricultural extension services, livestock health camps, or skill development initiatives–CSR acts as an extended arm of the system. It helps departments achieve targets while deepening impact.

At DBF, efforts are also made to ensure that every household is covered under at least one social security scheme. This not only enhances resilience but also reinforces the protective framework envisioned by public policy.

Convergence, therefore, does not merely add efforts–it multiplies outcomes.

Sustainability through Ownership and Partnerships

Sustainability cannot be an afterthought; it must be designed into interventions from the outset.

One effective approach has been fostering community ownership. For instance, reverse osmosis (RO) plants set up in villages are handed over to Panchayats for management. Communities take responsibility for operations, maintenance, and cost recovery through nominal user charges. This transforms beneficiaries into stakeholders.

Equally important are partnerships. Collaborations with institutions such as NABARD have enabled the formation and strengthening of Farmer Producer Organizations, benefiting thousands of farmers. Initiatives in integrated farming, watershed development, and tribal livelihoods have expanded impact across geographies.

Governments have also become outcome-based partners, supporting training linked directly to employment.

These examples underline a simple truth: partnership is not a strategy–it is a necessity.

CSR, ESG, and Business Responsibility

Today, businesses are evaluated not only on financial performance but also on how responsibly they operate. CSR is increasingly aligned with Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG) principles, making it central to long-term value creation.

Thriving businesses require stable and prosperous communities around them. In this context, CSR is not peripheral–it is integral. It is not just good ethics; it is sound economics.

The Human Dimension

Perhaps the most distinctive strength of CSR lies in its human dimension. Government systems operate at scale; CSR operates with proximity.

It listens, adapts, and evolves. Interventions are recalibrated and redesigned when necessary. But through this process, something more enduring is built–trust.

And trust is the foundation of participation, ownership, and sustainability.

From Comparison to Collaboration

The real strength of the social sector lies not in comparing government and CSR, but in combining them.

Government brings scale and reach.

CSR brings depth, flexibility, and innovation.

When scale meets sensitivity, when policy meets practice, and when intent meets execution–transformation happens.

Ultimately, the success of development is not measured by the number of schemes launched, but by how many people are able to access them, benefit from them, and shape their own future.

Views expressed are personal

News at a glance

Military plane with 32 people on board crashes in Nigeria

OHIO: A military aircraft crashed Monday in southern Nigeria with 25 passengers and 7 crew members on board, triggering a frantic rescue operation, authorities said.

The aircraft was on a routine mission to Nigeria's economic hub of Lagos when it crashed in the Igbokoda area of Ondo state, Nigeria's Aviation Minister Festus Keyamo said in a statement.

It was not immediately clear if there were any casualties, or to what extent the aircraft was damaged.

Romania logs 2 dead after fire onboard vessel in Black Sea

BUCHAREST: Romanian authorities said on Monday that two people have died after a fire on a commercial vessel which later sank in the Black Sea. Eleven crew members were rescued. Romania's Coast Guard was alerted at around 11 am local time, the Interior Ministry said.

The vessel was in Romania's exclusive economic zone, about 55 kilometres south of Sfantul Gheorghe in Tulcea County. The ministry did not identify the cause of the fire. Romanian news channels reported that the ship was a Turkish vessel.

Boat collision on Congo River killed at least 30 people

KINSHASA: Two boats collided over the weekend on the Congo River, killing at least 30 people and leaving dozens missing, local Congolese authorities said Monday.

The motorized wooden boats crashed into one another on Sunday near the Ngombe-Lukolela area in the province of Equateur, according to the provincial interior minister, Crispin Mputu. The reason for the crash was not immediately clear. The minister told The Associated Press that the 30 killed in the crash have already been buried.



A girl cries as she holds up a poster during a gathering marking the second anniversary of the assassinations of Hezbollah leaders Hassan Nasrallah and his successor, Hashem Safieddine AP/PTI

ADVANCE TOWARD KEY CITY OF TAIZ

Iran-backed Houthis seize another town in Yemen

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Aden, October 5

The Iran-backed Houthi rebels captured more territory in southwestern Yemen, taking a key town in a blow to the Saudi-backed government forces as they advanced Monday toward a strategic provincial capital in the region.

The fall of the town of Turbah came on Sunday, shortly before the internationally recognised government announced a major military operation against the Houthis. The escalation between Saudi Arabia and the Houthis has revived Yemen's civil war after a four-year ceasefire.

Turbah sits on a main road linking the provincial capital of Taiz with the port city of Aden, which serves as an interim seat of Yemen's government. Over the years, the town was a major post for the government forces defending Taiz against the Houthis.



Yahya Saree, spokesperson for the Houthis

Earlier, the Houthis seized several villages and areas on Taiz's outskirts in a series of advances, paving the way for the rebels to encircle Taiz, Yemen's third largest city. The Houthis made a swift push on the country's western coast on the Red Sea in early September. The rebels captured the strategic city of Mokha and several Red Sea islands, gains that enabled them to control the Yemeni side of the Bab al-Mandab Strait, a crucial chokepoint through which 12 per cent of global trade transits.

In their weekend announcement Sunday, the Saudi-backed government said it was mobilising troops across government-held areas.

Rashad al-Alimi, head of the ruling Presidential Leadership Council, said in a televised speech that the operations were aiming at "recovering the remaining territories" controlled by the Houthis.

HIGHLIGHTS

- The fall of the town of Turbah came on Sunday
- The escalation between Saudi Arabia and the Houthis has revived Yemen's civil war
- Earlier, Houthis seized several villages and areas on Taiz's outskirts

'Indians on board civilian ship hit by Russian drones in Black Sea'

Ukrainian President says captain of the ship killed

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
London, October 5

At least one person was killed while 11 others were rescued after a Russian drone strike caused a fire on a Turkish-owned civilian cargo vessel in the Black Sea carrying Indian and Azerbaijani citizens, Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said on Monday.

"A horrific strike by two Russian drones on a civilian vessel in neutral waters carrying corn and owned by Turkiye," he said in a post on X.

"Azerbaijani and Indian citizens were on board. As of now, unfortunately, we know that the ship's captain was killed. My condolences. The fate of one other person is still being established," he said.



Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy

Zelenskyy said 11 crew members were rescued, one of them injured.

He further said that Ukraine has repeatedly proposed concrete steps to de-escalate the situation and ensure security in the Black Sea.

"Pressure is needed to restore global food security. And everyone who is genuinely interested in this must help," he posted.

The Black Sea is a critical global trade choke point facing severe disruption due to escalating attacks on commercial shipping and port infrastructure from the ongoing Russia-Ukraine conflict.

On Sunday, a 52-year-old employee of a pharmaceutical warehouse belonging to Indian owners was killed in a Russian strike in Ukraine's Sumy.

On Sunday, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar said India has moved beyond advocacy and stepped up its efforts in recent months to resolve the Ukraine conflict by engaging in conversations with both Kyiv and Moscow.

Report: Worker at Siberian plague institute fell ill and died of an unknown cause

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Moscow, October 5

Russian authorities have quarantined a hospital and are monitoring contacts of an employee at a plague research institute in Siberia who contracted pneumonia of an "unknown" cause. Local state TV said the woman died last week.

Russian authorities said they found no evidence that her illness was caused by any of the pathogens she worked with. But the case has raised alarm in Russia after unconfirmed media reports suggested she might have died of pneumonic plague – a less common but severe form of plague that can spread from person to person.

The woman worked at Irkutsk Anti-Plague Research Institute of Siberia and the Far East in Irkutsk.

GOVERNMENT OF CHHATTISGARH, WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
WATER MANAGEMENT DIVISION NO. 1, RAIPUR (C.G.)
e-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE
eProcurement Portal: https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in

Online Tenders are invited for the following works up to 22.10.2026 of S. No. 1 at 17.30 Hours & 21.10.2026 of S. No. 2 at 17.30 Hours.
(As per S.O.R Enforced from Dated 01.05.2025 and amended on dated 08.08.2025) and as per SOR enforced from Dated 01.01.2025 of Public Work Department in S. NO. 2)

S. No.	System No.	NIT No. and Dated	Name of work	Amt.
1.	200542 First Call	11/SAC/2026-27 Raipur, Dated: 01.10.2026	Construction of Sandi Anicut across Kolhan Nalla in Block Arang, District Raipur	Rs. 314.83 Lakhs (Excluding G.S.T.)
2.	200558 Second Call	13/SAC/2026-27 Raipur, Dated: 01.10.2026	Renovation of Tar road from RD 38.30 Km. to 47.30 Km. of Mandhar Branch Canal of Mahanadi Project in Block Dharsiwa/Arang, District Raipur	Rs. 205.88 Lakhs (Excluding G.S.T.)

The details can be viewed and downloaded online directly from the Government of Chhattisgarh Integrated e-Procurement Portal (**https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in) from Date 08.10.2026, at 17.31 Hours.(IST) onwards**.

NOTE :- All eligible/intrested contractors/bidders are mandated to get enrolled on the Integrated e-procurement portal (**https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in**) and get approval on specific vendor class from PWD under Centralized Contractor/Supplier Registration in order to download the tender documents and participate in the subsequent bidding process.

Executive Engineer
Water Management Division No. 1, Raipur
For, Chief Engineer, Mahanadi Project
Raipur (C.G.)

G 262703729/ 5

UJVN LIMITED
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

Letter No: 913 **Tender Notice** Date: 05/10/2026

Office of the Executive Engineer (Civil), MB-II, Chinyalisaur (Uttarkashi) invites sealed tender from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:
Tender No: 30/ EE(Civil) / MB-II / Chinyalisaur / 2026-27
Name of work: Providing and fixing barbed wire fencing at nigam land around Dharasu Power House, MB-II, Chinyalisaur, Uttarkashi.
Estimated Cost: Rs. 7,06,654.00 (excluding GST)
Date of availability of bid document on website: 03.10.2026 from 5:00PM
Last date for submission of tender: 27.10.2026 upto 11:00AM
For fuller & further detail, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be download from the Nigam's website **"www.ujvnl.com"**

Executive Engineer (Civil),MB-II, Chinyalisaur.

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

NORTHERN RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. DEE-TRS-GZB acting for and on behalf of President of India invites E-Tender against Tender No. **230-TRS-GZB-2026-27-15-RT**. The details are as under:

1.	Name of the work:	'Comprehensive Repair/Renewal of CCB brake system in three phase electric locomotives' at Electric Loco Shed Ghaziabad.
2.	Approx. cost of work:	₹ 5,59,43,328.00
3.	Earnest Money to be deposited:	₹ 11,18,900.00
4.	Last Date & Time of Submission of tender bid of tender:	19-10-2026 (15:00 Hrs.)
5.	Date & Time of opening of tender document:	19-10-2026 (After 15:00 Hrs.)
6.	Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen:	www.ireps.gov.in

Note: (i) The tenderer/s must be registered on the Indian Railway E-Procurement System (IREPS) site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for participating in e-tender system.
(ii) For all terms and conditions please refer tender document.
(iii) No manual offers are acceptable.
(iv) Cost of Tender document and Earnest money will be acceptable through net banking or payment gateway only.
No. 230-TRS-GZB-2026-27-15-RT Dated: 24-09-2026 3437/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer/ Colony, N.E. Railway, Gorakhpur for and on behalf of President of India invites "OPEN" e-tender through online (e-tendering) for the following work: **Tender Notice No.: 15-2026-Colony; Name of Work:** Survey, Design, Manufacturing, Installation, Testing and Commissioning of IOT devices/ Intelligent Field Devices (IFDs) for monitoring & control (Indian Railways Native IOT based Yield Analysis Telemetry, Recording and Control -IR-NIYANTRAC) of Electrical General assets like Pumps, Street lighting, Lifts and Substations etc. and integration of solar monitoring portal for Dy. CEE/Colony area into IR-NIYANTRAC.; **Approx. Value:** ₹1,57,03,332/-; **E.M.D. Money:** ₹3,14,100/-; **Cost of Tender Form:** Zero; **Completion time/period from the date of issue of acceptance letter:** 06 Months. • E-Tender online will be submitted up to 15:00 hrs. on date 22.10.2026. • Manual offers are not allowed against these tenders and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railway IREPS official website **www.ireps.gov.in.**

Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer/Colony
CPRO/EL-208 **Gorakhpur**
DO NOT SMOKE BIDI/CIGARETTE IN TRAINS

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

The Divisional Track, Northern Railway, Delhi Division for and on behalf of President of India invites E-Tender on prescribed form for the following work.

Invitation of tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

1	Name of work with its location.	Supplying and stacking, loading and unloading of 71,640 Cum of 65 mm gauge machine-crushed hard stone ballast conforming to Railway Specification IS/RDSO-GE/0001:2023 (February 2023) and latest correction slips, from Ramkumarpura mining area, Village Ramkumarpura, Tehsil Khetri, District Jhunjhunu, Rajasthan, or Khanak mining area (under the control of HSIIDC), Tehsil Tosham, District Bhiwani, Haryana, or any other mining source producing similar quality machine crushed hard stone ballast as above, at Sub Depot No. 1 in Shakurbasti (SSB) Ballast Depot under DEN/Track/DLI. (NIT-12-26-27-WC)
2	Approx. cost of work.	(1) Rs. 15,19,99,502.20 /-
3	Earnest money.	(1) Rs. 30,40,000.00 /-
4	Date and Starting time for filling e-tender & Tender opening time	Starting time for filling e-tender is **Date-14/10/2026** at 15:00 hrs. & Tender opening time is **Date-28/10/2026** at 15:00 hrs.
5	Website particulars, published e-tender notice location etc. complete details of tender can be seen and web site where the tender form can be downloaded	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in

No: 128-W/Sr.DEN-C/NIT-12-26-27/WC Dated: 05/10/2026 3447/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

Muthoot Homefin
Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd.
CIN- U65922KL2011PLC029231
Corporate Office : Muthoot Homefin (INDIA) Ltd. 19/E, The Ruby, Senapati Bapat Marg, Tulsi Pipe Road, Near Ruparel College, Dadar West, Mumbai - 400028.
Branch Office: Muthoot Homefin India Ltd, B-12, First Floor, Tagore Market, Kirti Nagar Near by Ramesh Nagar, Oppsite Metro Pillor No 335 Mew Delhi 110015
Branch Office: Muthoot Homefin (I) Ltd, 2nd Floor, Baisoya Complex, Naya Bans, Above Syndicate Bank, Sector 15, Noida - 201301 U.P.

APPENDIX-IV-A [See proviso to Rule 8(6)]
PUBLIC NOTICE FOR AUCTION CUM SALE

Pursuant to taking possession of the secured asset mentioned hereunder by the Authorized Officer of Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd. under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 for the recovery of amount due from borrower/s, offers are invited by the undersigned in sealed covers for purchase of immovable property, as described hereunder, which is in the possession, on **'As Is Where Is Basis', 'As Is What Is Basis' and 'Whatever Is There Is Basis', Particulars of which are given below:-**

Sr. No.	Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/ Guarantor(s) / Loan Account No. / Branch	Demand Notice Date and Amount	Description of the Immovable property	Reserve Price	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) (10% of RP)
1.	Arun Kumar Singh/ Kanhiya Gautam/ DEL-HL-000701/ Delhi	11-Nov-2025/ Rs. 20,60,412/- Rupees Twenty Lakh Sixty Thousand Four Hundred Twelve Only.	Residential MIG Flat bearing no. GF-02 on Ground floor (back side) without roof rights having covered area measuring 700 sq ft (65.03 sq mtrs) situated in the residential colony known as DLF Ankur Vihar, Built on Plot no. C-10/18 in the area of village Sadulabad, Pargana, Tehsil and Dist-Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh	Rs.19,72,030/- Rupees Nineteen Lakh Seventy Two Thousand Thirty Only.	Rs.1,97,203/- Rupees One Lakh Ninety Seven Thousand Two Hundred Three Only.
2.	Sanju/ Neetu/ NOI-HL-001030/ Noida	11-Nov-2025/ Rs. 10,62,723/- Rupees Ten Lakh Sixty Two Thousand Seven Hundred Twenty Three Only.	Ground Floor -2 built up on Plot No. A-29 area measuring 42.5 sq. yards out of Khasra No. 208. situated at Sankar Vihar village Sadullabad Tehsil loni District Ghaziabad. Boundaries:- East- Rasta 20 feet wide, West- Service lane 8 feet wide, North-Plot No. A 30, Storage, South- Plot No. A 28	Rs.11,85,480/- Rupees Eleven Lakh Eighty Five Thousand Four Hundred Eighty Only.	Rs.1,18,548/- Rupees One Lakh Eighteen Thousand Five Hundred Fourty Eight Only.

1. The Auction is being held on **"AS IS WHERE IS" AND "AS IS WHAT IS" basis**
2. The detailed terms and conditions of the auction sale are incorporated in the prescribed tender form, available at the above mentioned regional office
3. Last Date of Submission of Sealed Bid/Offer in the prescribed tender forms along with EMD payable by way of Demand Draft in Favor of 'Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd'. along with KYC is on **17-Nov-26 till 04:00 PM** at Regional Office the address mentioned herein above. Tenders that are not filled up completely or tenders received beyond last date will be considered as invalid tender and shall accordingly be rejected. No interest shall be paid on the EMD.
4. Date of Inspection of the Immovable Property is on **16-Nov-26 between 01:00 P.M. to 03:00 P.M.**
5. Date of Opening of the Bid/Offer Auction Date for Property is **18-Nov-26** at the above mentioned Branch Office address at **01:00 PM.** by the Authorised Officer.
6. The MHIL shall not be responsible for payment of any outstanding statutory notice & Encumbrances / taxes arrears etc. if any & their Responsible to pay the sum would be that of the Successful auction purchase. The Intending bidder should make their own independent inquiries regarding the Encumbrances Title of property & also inspect & satisfy themselves.
7. The Highest bidder shall be subject to approval of MHIL Ltd. Authorised Officer shall Reserve the right to accept all any of the offer /Bid so received without assign any reason whatsoever. His decision shall be final and binding.
8. The Borrower(s)/Guarantor(s) are hereby given 30 DAYS SALE NOTICE UNDER THE SARFAESI ACT, 2002 to pay the sum mentioned as above before the date of Auction failing which the immovable property will be auctioned and balance, if any, will be recovered with interest and costs. If the Borrower pays the amount due to Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd, in full, before the date of sale, auction is liable to be set aside.

For further details, contact the Authorised Officer, at the above mentioned Office address Contact Person- **Amit Verma-9013255520**

Date: October 06, 2026 Place: Ghaziabad **Sd/- Authorized Officer, Muthoot Homefin (India) Limited**

वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक का कार्यालय पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर

लापताः आवश्यक सूचना



नाबालिक बालिका प्राची सिन्हा उर्फ लक्की, उम्र–13 वर्ष

सर्व साधारण को सूचित करना है कि आवेदिका सह माताजी प्रिती कुमारी सिन्हा उम्र–32 वर्ष के द्वारा **अपनी पुत्री प्राची सिन्हा उर्फ लक्की उम्र–13 वर्ष की गुमशुदगी** के संबंध में संबंधित थाना कदमा में लिखित आवेदन दिये हैं। आवेदन में इनके द्वारा बताया गया कि गुमशुदा प्राची सिन्हा उर्फ लक्की उम्र–13 वर्ष, पिता–रोहित कुमार पाठक, स्थायी पता–ग्राम–बेलहारी, थाना–तरीया, जिला –छपरा (बिहार), वर्तमान पता–रामनगर रोड़ नं0–07 (पवन दुबे के घर में किरायेदार), जिम पार्क के पास, थाना–कदमा, जिला–पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर जो दिनांक–11.09.2026 को समय करीब शाम 05:00 बजे अपने घर रामनगर से सोनारी मोबाईल बनाने के लिए बोलकर निकली थी और अबतक घर वापस नहीं आई है।

परिवारवालों ने अपने स्तर से काफी खोजबीन किया परन्तु कुछ पता नहीं चल सका। **गुमशुदा का हुलिया निम्न प्रकार है :–कद–05 फीट 02 इंच, रंग–गोरी, शरीर–पतली–दुबली, पहनावा–शर्ट नीला रंग का, जीन्स काला रंग का एवं पैर में चप्पल।**

अतः आप सभी जन साधारण से अनुरोध है कि उपरोक्त अपहृता के संबंध में किसी प्रकार की जानकारी प्राप्त होती है तो इसकी सूचना वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक, पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर के कार्यालय में निम्नांकित फोन नम्बर पर सूचित करें।

वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक, पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर : 0657–2431006
पुलिस अधीक्षक (नगर), पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर : 9471190203
पुलिस उपाधीक्षक, (मु0–2) : 9431706487
थाना प्रभारी, कदमा : 9431706506

वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक,
पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर

PR 391125 (Police)26-27*D

HQ District Police,
Ramban
dpo.ramban12@jkpolice.gov.in

NO:-CB/Look out Notice/2026/ 55115/40 **Dated: -** 30- 09-2026

LOOK OUT NOTICE

As intimated by SHO, Police Station Ramsoo vide letter No. 557/5-A/PSR dated 29-09-2026, that on 28-09-2026, one person namely Shabir Ahmed S/O Fareed Ahmed R/O Dhalgote Chakka, Tehsil Ramsoo, District Ramban, approached at Police Station Ramsoo and produced a written application alleging therein that on 28.09.2026 at about 0400 hours his daughter namely Nasreena Banoo is missing from her residence. He searched her, but no clue struck out. On this a missing report was entered at Police Station Ramsoo vide DDR No.12 dated 28-09-2026. The photograph and Description of missing girl are as under:-

Description Role

Name: - Nasreena Banoo
D/O:- Shabir Ahmed
R/O: - Dhalgote, Chakka, Tehsil Ramsoo District Ramban UT of J&K.
Age: - 18 Years 05 Months.
Height:- 5 Ft. (Approx)
Complexion: Fair
Dress: Red color



It is therefore requested that a sharp lookout may kindly be maintained in your respective jurisdictions. If traced or any clue leading to the above said missing girl is struck out, immediate information may kindly be shared on the below mentioned E-mail/Phone numbers.

E-mail: ID dpo.ramban12@jkpolice.gov.in,
PCR Ramban:- 9906926079, 9906925595.
SHO P/S Ramsoo:- 9419157737.
P/S Ramsoo:- 9103011697, 9149769670

DIP No:DIP/J-11779/26

I/C Superintendent of Police,
Ramban.

News at a glance

Central Bank credit growth up 30% to ₹3.81 lakh cr in Q2

NEW DELHI: State-owned Central Bank of India on Monday reported 30 per cent growth in credit to Rs 3.81 lakh crore in the second quarter of the financial year, compared with Rs 2.93 lakh crore a year ago. Total deposits rose 14 per cent to Rs 5.08 lakh crore from Rs 4.44 lakh crore at the end of the year-ago quarter, the bank said in a regulatory filing.

Total business increased 21 per cent to Rs 8.89 lakh crore from over Rs 7.37 lakh crore during the same period. The bank's CASA deposits rose 9 per cent to Rs 2.26 lakh crore at the end of the second quarter, compared with the year-ago period.

L&T CMD bats for longer tenures for heads of PSUs

NEW DELHI: L&T Chairman & MD S N Subrahmanyan on Monday called for around five-year tenures for PSU heads, saying frequent leadership changes hurt large project planning and execution.

"India has fantastic people with high pedigree and strong implementation capabilities," but one- or two-year tenures prevent long-term planning, he said at the Indian Foundation for Quality Management Symposium 2026. He said longer tenures would help conceive and complete projects, while changes in government leadership imperil project implementation, cost, time and quality.

Bharat Forge secures Pratt & Whitney aerospace contract

MUMBAI: Bharat Forge Ltd on Monday said it has secured a long-term contract from Pratt & Whitney Canada to supply mission-critical aerospace engine components. The components will be manufactured at Bharat Forge's aerospace facility in India, the company said.

"We look forward to supporting Pratt & Whitney Canada's programs & furthering India's advancement in aerospace manufacturing expertise," Amit Kalyani, Vice-Chairman & Joint MD, Bharat Forge, said. Bharat Forge supplies safety-critical components to automotive, power, defence, aerospace sectors globally.

SAIL crude steel output grows to 9.6 MT in April-September

NEW DELHI: Steel Authority of India Ltd (SAIL) reported a 1 per cent rise in crude steel production to 9.6 million tonnes during April-September, compared with the year-ago period. Hot metal output increased 2 per cent year-on-year to 10.2 million tonnes, while finished steel production rose 1 per cent to 8.39 million tonnes during the first half of FY27, SAIL said.

The share of finished steel in total saleable steel production improved to 89.2 per cent from 86.8 per cent in April-September 2025. Dispatches of long rails and wheels & axles to Indian Railways increased 7 per cent and 3 per cent, respectively, during the period.

PVT LENDERS' DEPOSIT GROWTH RANGED BETWEEN 17%-34%

Private banks' deposit mobilisation outpaces PSB peers in Sept quarter

Deposit growth of PSBs ranged between 6.87-17.01%, the data compiled from provisional numbers disclosed by banks for Q2 FY27 shows

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, October 5

Deposit mobilisation by private banks outpaced state-owned peers in the second quarter of FY27, indicating higher Foreign Currency Non-Resident Bank deposit mobilisation under the Reserve Bank's concessional swap window.

Data compiled from provisional numbers disclosed by banks for the Q2 FY27 shows that private lenders' deposit growth ranged between 17 per cent and 34 per cent year-on-year against a 6.87-17.01 per cent rise of state-owned lenders.

In the private space, HDFC Bank reported an 18.8 per cent year-on-year deposit growth in Q2, Kotak Mahindra Bank (23.2 per cent), YES Bank (19.5 per cent), Axis Bank (20.7 per cent), IDFC First Bank (17 per cent), RBL Bank (34 per cent) & South India Bank (18.70 per cent).

In the PSB space, Bank of Baroda registered the highest growth of 17.01 per cent year-on-year in domestic deposits and 16.75 per cent in global deposits in Q2 FY27, followed by Central Bank of India (14.43 per cent), UCO Bank (14.05 per cent), and Punjab and Sind Bank (12.98 per cent).



IN THE PRIVATE SPACE, HDFC BANK REPORTED AN 18.8% YEAR-ON-YEAR DEPOSIT GROWTH IN Q2, KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK (23.2%), YES BANK (19.5%), AXIS BANK (20.7%), IDFC FIRST BANK (17%), RBL BANK (34%), AND SOUTH INDIA BANK (18.70%), ACCORDING TO DATA

Punjab National Bank reported 9.90 per cent year-on-year growth in global deposits and 9.44 per cent in domestic space. Canara Bank's global deposits grew 13.13 per cent, and domestic deposits rose 10.96 per cent.

Indian Bank and Union Bank of India's total deposits grew 12.4 per cent and 6.87 per cent, respectively.

"System deposit growth picked up from 11-12 per cent to 17 per cent year-on-year with strong FCNR(B) inflows of $133 billion, which accounted for 4.5 per cent of system deposits," Motilal Oswal Financial Services said in a report.

The Reserve Bank of India's special USD-INR forex swap facility for FCNR (B) deposits, Overseas Foreign Currency Borrowings (OFCB) and External Commercial Borrowings (ECBs) was launched on June 8, 2026. The scheme was open till August 31 for FCNR(B) deposits, and will be open until December 31, 2026, for ECBs and OFCBs.

As of August 31, banks have mobilised $133 billion through the special Foreign Currency Non-Resident (FCNR-B) deposit scheme.

FCNR(B) deposits are fixed-term deposits held in foreign currencies, with the principal and interest repaid in the same currency, shielding depositors from direct rupee exchange-rate risk. The arrangement allows non-resident Indians to place foreign-currency funds with Indian banks without taking direct rupee-currency risk.

From a loan growth perspective, state-run banks' advances growth remained in the range of 12.59-29.83 per cent year-on-year in Q2, while private banks' growth ranged from 16.3-40 per cent during the same period.

Motilal Oswal said systemic credit growth remained healthy at 18.8 per cent as of September 15, 2026, driven by sustained retail demand and higher utilisation levels by MSME borrowers, healthy corporate borrowings due to elevated bond yields, and higher-than-expected FCNR(B) flows supporting the growth momentum.

The report further said net interest margins (NIMs) for private banks are expected to be adversely impacted by rapid business growth owing to FCNR(B) inflows and the leverage provided by the banks against the same.

KEY POINTS

- In the PSB space, Bank of Baroda registered the highest growth of 17.01% in domestic deposits & 16.75% in global deposits in Q2 FY27, followed by Central Bank of India (14.43%), UCO Bank (14.05%), and Punjab & Sind Bank (12.98%)
- PNB reported 9.90% growth in global deposits & 9.44% in domestic space. Canara Bank's global deposits grew 13.13%, and domestic deposits rose 10.96%
- Indian Bank and Union Bank of India's total deposits grew 12.4 per cent and 6.87 per cent, respectively

IndiGo to hike fuel surcharge for domestic, int'l flights from Oct 6

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 5



THE QUANTUM OF THE HIKE RANGES FROM Rs 100 TO Rs 350 FOR DOMESTIC FLIGHTS DEPENDING ON DISTANCE

The country's largest airline IndiGo on Monday announced a hike in fuel surcharge for domestic and international flights in the wake of rising jet fuel prices. The revised charges will be effective from October 6, and the move will push airfares higher.

The quantum of the hike ranges from Rs 100 to Rs 350 for domestic flights depending on distance. The hike in surcharge has also been effected for international flights. This is the second time since April that the carrier has increased the fuel surcharge, which was introduced in March.

The fuel surcharge will be Rs 375 for routes with distance up to 500 kilometres and Rs 600 for flights having distance between 501 and 1,000 kilometres.

The amount will be Rs 900 for routes with a distance of 1,001 to 1,500 kilometres and Rs 1,150 for a distance of 1,501 to 2,000 kilometres. The statement said the fuel surcharge will be Rs 1,300 for flights having a distance of more than 2,000 kilometres.

For SAARC region flights, the fuel surcharge varies from Rs 1,000 to Rs 3,000 and Rs 6,000 for Africa flights and Rs 10,000 for Europe services. The fuel surcharge will be Rs 5,500 for flights to Southeast Asia, GCC and the Middle East, and North and East Asia, as per the statement.

Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF) accounts for around 40 per cent of an airline's operating costs. IndiGo said ATF prices have remained volatile in recent months, especially following the geopolitical situation in the Middle East.

According to the airline, the continuous rise in fuel prices, with the latest month-on-month increase exceeding 14 per cent, has taken ATF costs to levels that are amongst the highest in the last decade.

"Given that ATF makes up a significant share of the airline's operating costs, this rise is expected to impact airlines' cost structures and network economics, including those of IndiGo," it said in a statement on Monday. In view of the situation, the airline said it has marginally recalibrated its fuel charges across its domestic and international flights.

While offsetting the increase in fuel costs would have required a significantly larger increase in fuel charges, a measured and relatively modest adjustment to minimise the impact on customers has been made, the airline said. Regretting the additional burden the revised fuel charges would have on travellers, the airline said the decision reflects the sustained increase in operating costs and evolving market environment.

IndiGo operates over 2,200 flights daily.

On October 1, ATF prices were hiked by a steep Rs 16 to Rs 137 per litre from Rs 121 for domestic airlines. The revision came after the jet fuel prices were raised by Rs 6.28 per litre, or 5.46 per cent, in September, following a Rs 5 per litre increase in August. In April, Air India announced revisions to fuel surcharges while Akasa Air started levying a fuel surcharge from March 15 amid the spike in ATF prices.

Tea Board holds seminar on e-auction process



MPOST BUREAU
Kolkata, October 5

The Tea Board on Monday held a seminar on e-auction where industry experts shared their views on the pros and cons of the e auction process and how it was industry friendly. Among the experts were Kavi Seth, Ajit Raha, Ishtpreet Singh, and Gopal Podder.

C Murugan, deputy chairman of Tea Board said he was implementing the recommendations of studies done for the past couple of years. It is to take some steps for reforms. We got inputs from auctioners ." He said this

reform of Tea Board is to ensure there is

no entry barrier for buyers as Tea Board wants to provide better service to the tea consumers.

Murugan also felicitated heritage tea stall owners including one from Serampore which is over 113 years old. Even the tea stall owners of Balwant Singh Dhaba and Chitta shop were honoured. Murugan said we are branding heritage tea stalls

New framework for BIT to get Cabinet nod soon: Sitharaman

AGENCIES
New Delhi, October 5

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Monday said a new template for bilateral investment treaties is ready and is expected to receive Cabinet approval soon, with the aim of making it more investor-friendly.

The template, prepared over the last one-and-a-half years, seeks to address shortcomings in the 2016 model and provide stronger protection to investors from both countries, she said. India has continued negotiations on investment protection agreements while finalising the new framework, Sitharaman said at the Munich Security Conference.

The latest agreement with Saudi Arabia goes beyond the 2016 framework, while India has also concluded similar pacts with the UAE, Oman & some Central Asian countries.

Negotiations are underway with Canada and Russia, among others. If talks progress, India could conclude agreements with at least three more countries by December, she said.

The minister said the earlier framework does not adequately serve India's interests. It requires foreign investors to pursue domestic remedies for five years before initiating treaty-based arbitration.

On the India-US trade agreement, Sitharaman said negotiations remain ongoing and have been "hard and very rigorously" conducted, with trade imbalance a key issue.

Jio Platforms IPO to open for subscription on October 21, listing likely on October 28

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 5

The initial public offering of Jio Platforms, which is expected to be the country's biggest issue, is likely to open for subscription on October 21, sources aware of the development said.

Shares of the digital services major are likely to be listed on the stock exchanges on October 28, sources added.

The company is likely to get listed by the end of this month at an enterprise valuation of $143-146 billion or above Rs 12 lakh crore.

"The issue will open for subscription from October 21 to October 23 after completion of the anchor round on October 19. The shares are expected to get listed on October 28 for public trading," one of the sources tracking the development said.

An email query sent to Jio Platforms Ltd (JPL) did not elicit any reply.

Jio Platforms IPO is touted as India's largest public offer at an estimated size of $3.8 billion.

The company has concluded overseas roadshows and is expected to file final papers with market regulator Sebi for the IPO in the week starting October 12.

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) issued its final observations on August 28. Jio Platforms had filed its draft IPO papers in June.

According to its draft prospectus, the company plans to issue up to 27 crore fresh equity shares, equivalent to about 2.9 per cent of its post-issue equity base. Sources have indicated that the company may raise around $3.8 billion from the public offer.

The IPO comes as India's primary market has seen heightened action, with strong participation from retail investors and domestic institutions.

More than two dozen IPOs have been announced or launched since July 1, nearly matching the 28 recorded in the first half of 2026.

Indian workers spend avg ₹785/month to reach office: Survey

Urban workers incur higher costs of Rs 1,044 compared with Rs 612 for rural workers, says survey

AGENCIES
New Delhi, October 5

Workers spend an average of Rs 785 per month commuting to fixed workplaces, with urban workers incurring higher costs of Rs 1,044 compared with Rs 612 for rural workers, according to the first-ever National Household Travel Survey (NHTS).

The National Statistics Office (NSO), under the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI), released key findings from the survey conducted between July 2025 and June 2026. A trip was defined as travel covering more than 1 km.

Male workers spend Rs 835 per month on fixed-workplace commutes against Rs 533 for female workers. About 57.6 per cent of workers travel more than 1 km to work, while 61.9 per cent of male workers undertake such daily trips compared with 41.9 per cent of female workers.

Two-wheelers are the largest primary transport mode for workers, accounting for 37.1 per cent of rural and 52.3 per cent of urban commutes. Monorail, metro, suburban rail and trams account for 5 per cent of urban worker commutes nationally, rising to 20.7 per cent in Maharashtra, 16.5 per cent in West Bengal and 14.4 per cent in Delhi.

About 83.4 per cent of workers commute in under 30 minutes. The share reaching fixed workplaces within half an hour is 86.1 per cent in rural areas and 79.3 per cent in urban areas, while 13.7 per cent take 30-60 minutes.

Average travel time is 25 minutes for workers travelling to fixed workplaces, including 23 minutes in rural areas and 27 minutes in urban areas. States such as Rajasthan, Gujarat and Madhya Pradesh record travel times of around 20-23 minutes, while parts of southern India report higher times.

Urban students spend Rs 617 monthly commuting to educational institutions against Rs 361 in rural India. About 66.4 per cent of students commute more than 1 km daily, while 86.6 per cent of rural and 89.6 per cent of urban students complete journeys within 30 minutes.

About 37 per cent of school students walk to school, followed by buses at 29.5 per cent and bicycles at 15.8 per cent. Auto-rickshaws account for 10.5 per cent of student commutes, while two-wheelers account for 6.7 per cent.

About 73.5 per cent of overnight trips rely on buses and rail. Buses account for 55.8 per cent and inter-city railways 17.7 per cent, followed by cars at 15.1 per cent and two-wheelers at 8.8 per cent. Rail usage is about 14 per cent among rural households and 22.7 per cent among urban households.

CLOSER LOOK

- Male workers spend Rs 835 per month on fixed-workplace commutes against Rs 533 for female workers
- About 57.6% of workers travel more than 1 km to work, while 61.9% of male workers undertake such daily trips compared with 41.9% of female workers
- Two-wheelers are the largest primary transport mode for workers, accounting for 37.1% of rural and 52.3% of urban commutes

POWER TO ARREST IS LIMITED TO SERIOUS OFFENCES

GST enforcement likey to shift from 'arrest' to 'detect, recover & prosecute'

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 5

The GST enforcement framework might soon see significant changes with tax officers likely to lose the power to arrest evaders, as part of decriminalisation of the GST law.

The 57th meeting, to be held on October 8, is likely to take up policy reforms that include change in enforcement provision.

If the GST Council, comprising Union and state finance ministers, approves the proposal, the Goods and Services Tax enforcement could shift to judicial oversight from departmental arrest, while reserving criminal prosecution for serious and deliberate tax fraud. Here is a quick look into how the law stands as of date and what the proposed reforms in enforcement under GST 2.0 entail.

Current GST Law and Enforcement

Under the current provisions, Commissioner-level officers are empowered to authorise any Central or State Tax Officer to arrest such a person who has committed specified offences under the law.



IF THE PROPOSAL IS APPROVED, THE GST ENFORCEMENT COULD SHIFT FROM DEPARTMENTAL ARREST TO JUDICIAL OVERSIGHT

The power to arrest is principally limited to serious offences, including issuing fake invoices, availing or utilising fraudulent ITC, and collecting tax but failing to deposit it with the government within the prescribed period.

The law also distinguishes between bailable and non-bailable offences. Offences involving the specified categories where the amount exceeds Rs 5 crore are classified as cognizable and non-bailable. Offences below that threshold, subject to the statutory framework, are generally non-cognizable and bailable.

Section 69 of GST talks about the power to a GST officer to make an arrest – "Where the Commissioner has reasons to believe that a person has committed any offence ... he may, by order, authorise any officer of central tax to arrest such person". Once arrested, the person is to be produced before a magistrate within 24 hours.

KEY POINTS

- Under the current provisions, Offences involving the specified categories where the amount exceeds Rs 5 crore are classified as cognizable and non-bailable
- For businesses, the reform would be a big relief as they would not be subject to 'harassment' of sudden arrests by tax officers. Instead arrests would be made only after due hearing in a court of law

Current Arrest Mechanism

After approval from a Commissioner-level officer, GST officers can seek assistance from local police and certain other government authorities for implementing the provisions of the GST law. GST arrests are carried out by authorised Central or State Tax Officers and not by the local police.

The role of police is primarily supportive. GST officers cannot retain an arrested person in their custody indefinitely. The arrested person has to be presented before a magistrate within 24 hours.

Once the person is produced before the magistrate, the decision on bail or further remand rests with the court. The magistrate may grant bail or remand the person to judicial custody in accordance with the applicable criminal procedure law, currently governed by the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023 (BNSS).

What May Change For Businesses, Tax Officers

The proposal does not mean that GST officers would not chase tax demands or that frauds would become consequence-free. Taxpayers would continue to face proceedings for recovery of tax, interest and applicable penalties.

For businesses, this reform would be a big relief as they would not be subject to "harassment" of sudden arrests by tax officers. Instead arrests would be made only after due hearing in a court of law.

For GST officers, the proposed changes would mean that they would focus on getting taxes from evaders and let law enforcement agencies deal with arrests in cases of serious offences. They would continue to have powers of search and seizure as well to summon persons to give evidence and produce documents.

Regular GST disputes are likely to be addressed through adjudication, recovery, interest and penalties, while the criminal law would be focused on cases involving genuine and substantial fraud.

Markets rebound as Sensex climbs 473 points, Nifty ends above 22,500

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, October 5

Benchmark equity indices Sensex and Nifty ended higher on Monday amid a buying rush after a spell of heavy selloff, as easing oil supply concerns and positive global cues boosted investor sentiment.

Softer-than-expected US jobs data reduced fears of further monetary tightening by the US Federal Reserve, leading to positive momentum across global markets.

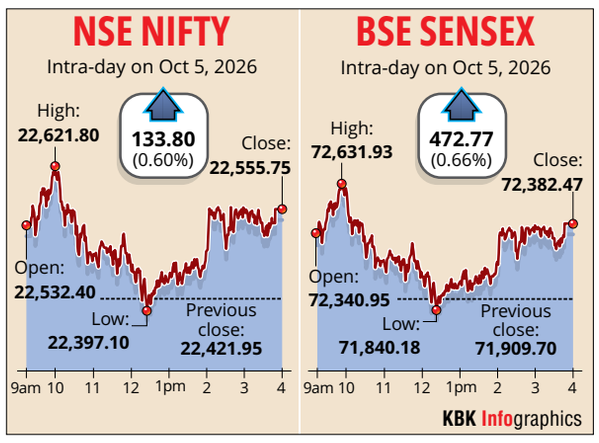
The 30-share BSE Sensex jumped 472.77 points, or 0.66 per cent, to settle at 72,382.47.

The 50-share NSE Nifty climbed 133.80 points, or 0.60 per cent, to end at 22,555.75.

From the 30 Sensex firms, ITC, Eternal, Bharti Airtel, Bajaj Finance, Adani Ports, ICICI Bank, Reliance Industries and Larsen & Toubro were among the major winners. HCL Tech, HDFC Bank, Sun Pharma, Infosys and Asian Paints were among the laggards.

The BSE SmallCap Select index climbed 0.52 per cent and the MidCap Select index advanced 0.44 per cent.

Among the BSE sectoral indices, Telecommunication jumped 2.10 per cent, MidSmall Private Banks Quality Tilt 1.79 per cent, MidSmall Private Banks 1.67 per cent, FMCG 1.45 per cent, Services 1.05 per cent and Consumer Durables (0.82 per cent). Hospitals, Healthcare, IT and Insurance were the laggards.



RUPEE DEPRECIATED 10 PAISE TO CLOSE AT 96.35 AGAINST THE US DOLLAR, AS ELEVATED OIL PRICES AND FOREIGN FUND OUTFLOWS KEPT THE RUPEE RANGE-BOUND NEAR CRITICAL 96 LEVEL

The rupee depreciated 10 paise to close at 96.35 against the US dollar on Monday, as elevated oil prices and persistent foreign fund outflows kept the Indian currency range-bound near the critical 96 level against the US dollar.

In Asian markets, Japan's Nikkei 225 index jumped over 2 per cent, while the Hang Seng index ended marginally higher. Equity markets were closed in South Korea and Shanghai for holidays. Markets in Europe were trading on a mixed note. US markets ended higher on Friday.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, was up 0.19 per cent to $102.4 per barrel. FIIs offloaded equities worth Rs 9,484.22 crore on Thursday, according to exchange data.

GST Council likely to align export definition with forex earnings

AGENCIES
New Delhi, October 5

The GST Council on October 8 may consider a proposal to align the definition of exports with commercial activities generating forex and remove ambiguity over services supplied through an Indian company's overseas branch, sources said.

The proposal seeks to address cases where Indian exporters operate through overseas branches, with foreign clients contracting and making payments through the local office.

Currently, GST law requires that the supplier & recipient of services should not be establishments of the same person for a transaction to qualify as exports. The Council is likely to consider removing this condition. "What decides the question now is whether the customer is abroad," sources said. Export of goods & services is zero-rated under GST.

AMRG Global Managing Partner Rajat Mohan said the changes could cut litigation & benefit IT/ITeS, BPO/KPO, GCCs, R&D centres, testing laboratories, engineering and design firms by supporting zero-rated treatment and refunds.

GST council may consider recasting tax officers' panels

AGENCIES
New Delhi, October 5

Nine years after the rollout of the GST, the GST Council is likely to consider recasting its tax officers' committees into a leaner structure as the indirect tax regime matures, sources said.

The proposed structure would have three bodies – the Secretariat, the GST Implementation Committee (GIC) and a standing committee of officers. Currently, the framework comprises the Secretariat, GIC, eight standing committees.

Sources said the GST system has stabilised and its rate structure was settled last year, allowing continuing work to be handled through a smaller arrangement.

Under the proposed structure, the GIC would remain the deciding body, taking up matters referred by the Secretariat and deciding issues delegated by the Council.

It would refer matters to the Secretary, Union Finance Minister or Council, & continue handling technology-related grievances.

The standing committee would undertake technical work, including examining proposals to amend laws, rules, notifications and forms, simplifying procedures and considering trade and industry representations. Its membership would reflect each state's relative size in the GST system and rotate every two years, with no state having a permanent seat.

Sources said the reform would emphasise political ownership of proposals from the start and greater transparency.

GST, launched on July 1, 2017, subsumed multiple taxes, including excise, service tax and VAT, into a unified regime. Committees were needed to address implementation issues and rate proposals. The proposed restructuring indicates the system has matured, sources said.

RBI absorbs ₹2.10L cr via two VRRR auctions

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mumbai, October 5

The RBI on Monday absorbed Rs 2,10,192 crore liquidity from the banking system via two overnight Variable Rate Reverse Repo (VRRR) auctions.

During the first auction, the central bank received bids worth Rs 2,10,688 crore for a notified amount of Rs 2 lakh crore. It accepted Rs 2,00,050 crore at a weighted average rate of 5.24 per cent.

However, the response from banks in the second auction was tepid, with just Rs 10,142 crore in bids for a notified amount of Rs 50,000 crore, which the central bank accepted fully.

Over the last two months, the central bank has undertaken multiple VRRR auctions to absorb excess surplus liquidity from the banking system and align the overnight money market rates to the repo rate.

Currently, liquidity in the banking system is estimated to be in surplus of around Rs 5.16 lakh crore as on October 4, as per RBI data.

The banking system has been flush with liquidity due to heavy mobilisation of FCNR (B) deposits, as the money brought foreign currency into the system, while subsequent swaps with the RBI provided rupee liquidity to banks.

LIC Mutual Fund appoints Ashis Kumar as MD & CEO



AGENCIES
New Delhi, October 5

LIC Mutual Fund has appointed Ashis Kumar as its Managing Director and CEO, effective September 26, the company said in a statement.

Kumar has over three decades of experience across investments, business operations, distribution, marketing and enterprise leadership. He previously served as CEO of LIC Mutual Fund.

He has also held several senior positions at LIC, including Chief (Investment) and Secretary (Investment) at the corporation's central office.

"The Indian asset management industry stands at an important inflection point. I am happy to be part of this journey. LIC Mutual Fund has a strong legacy, a trusted brand, and a growing presence across investor segments," Kumar said.

He said his focus would be on consistent investment outcomes, stronger products and distribution, improved investor experience, and leveraging technology for scale and efficiency.

Tata Steel expanding NINL capacity to 5 MT/annum: CEO

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 5

Tata Steel is ramping up capacity at its Neelachal Ispat Nigam Limited (NINL) facility to around 5 million tonnes per annum with a substantial capital investment, its CEO and MD TV Narendran said on Monday.

The top company official made these remarks on the sidelines of the Indian Foundation for Quality Management (IFQM) Symposium 2026 in the national capital. "So, we have already announced another 5 million tonne expansion in Neelachal, which is also in Kalinganagar. It is a long products expansion, and we have announced that it is a Rs 40,000 crore project," Narendran said in reply to a question on its growth plans.

On July 4, 2022, Tata Steel completed the acquisition of Odisha-based NINL, the first state-owned steel company to be divested by the Narendra Modi-led government, through its erstwhile subsidiary Tata Steel Long Products (TSLP) for Rs 12,100 crore.

NINL's 1 million tonne per annum (MTPA) steel manufacturing unit at Kalinganagar, around 120 km from Bhubaneswar, was closed for over three years on account of various reasons, including lack of funds. In May last year, Tata Steel announced the completion of the phase II expansion project at Tata Steel Kalinganagar in Odisha, taking its overall capacity to 26.1 million tonnes (MT) in the country.

Digital Chhattisgarh secures FDI proposals of ₹43,250 cr at SING Forum 2026 in Singapore

MPOST BUREAU
Singapore, October 5

Chhattisgarh secured FDI commitments worth Rs 43,250 crore at the inaugural SING Forum 2026 in Singapore, led by a Rs 41,750 crore commitment for an AI-ready data centre campus. Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai led the state delegation at the forum, where Chhattisgarh participated on the nomination of the Ministry of External Affairs.

Singapore-headquartered Energy Capital Global Pte Ltd committed Rs 41,750 crore to establish a 100 MW AI-ready data centre campus. Sai handed the company an Invitation to Invest.



Sunstream Green Energy Pvt Ltd committed another Rs 1,500 crore for solar projects, battery storage & components. Sai said the commitments reflected confidence in Chhattisgarh's policies and potential.

Singapore Minister of State for Foreign Affairs and Trade and Industry Gan Siow Huang attended as Guest of Honour. Representatives of Mastercard, IHCL and Nestlé also addressed the forum. Sai separately met Aquatech and Adroit Overseas Pte Ltd to discuss industrial wastewater reuse & food processing opportunities.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



R Doraiswamy, Managing Director & CEO, Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC), inaugurated the All India LIC Games 2026–27 at Sree Kanteerava Stadium, Bengaluru, on Monday. The inaugural ceremony was attended by S Girija, Executive Director (HRD & Training); Pradeep P Shenoy, Executive Director (Corporate Communication); Lata Madampath, Executive Director (Personnel); Saravana Ramesh S, Zonal Manager, South Central Zone and R K Yadav, Senior Divisional Manager, Bengaluru Division–1.

Dibrugarh sends 1st international cargo from Bogibeel to Bangladesh since independence

MPOST BUREAU
Dibrugarh, October 5

A barge carrying 540 metric tons of methanol left Bogibeel Terminal in Dibrugarh for Dhaka, Bangladesh, marking the first cargo shipment from upper Assam to a foreign port since India's independence in 1947.

Union Minister for Ports, Shipping & Waterways Sarbananda Sonowal flagged off the DLB Patkai, pushed by tug Kushal Konwar, while Assam Chief Minister Dr Himanta Biswa Sarma joined virtually. The methanol, produced by state-owned Assam Petrochemicals Ltd (APCL) at Namrup, is bound for Pangaon Port in Dhaka. The vessel will travel about 768 kilometres along National Waterway-2 on the Brahmaputra to the Indo-Bangladesh border before continuing on the Indo-Bangladesh Protocol Route.

The voyage is being seen as a test of the Brahmaputra's potential as a commercially viable freight corridor linking the Northeast with overseas markets. Regular methanol shipments are planned, with the movement enabled by customs and immigration complexes recently established at Bogibeel and Dhubri.

Sarma called it a proud day for Assam, saying the state's product made in Namrup was travelling to an international market on Assam's own river.

Dibrugarh's river trade declined after Partition in 1947 and a 1950 earthquake altered the riverbed. Regular bookings stopped in 1954 and the ghat closed on October 15, 1956. The 1965 India-Pakistan war suspended cross-border river trade, while India and Bangladesh signed a river trade protocol in 1972.

The 891-kilometre Brahmaputra stretch from Sadiya to Dhubri was declared National Waterway-2 in 1988, with regular cargo services beginning in December 2017. Tata Steel barges reached Pandu through Bangladesh in February 2022, followed by MV Ganga Vilas in 2023.

According to MoPSW, national waterways cargo rose from 18 million metric tons in 2013-14 to 218 million metric tons in 2025-26. More than 68 billion rupees is being invested in Northeast waterways.

SC stays action against Tata Chemicals over environmental damage

AGENCIES
New Delhi, October 5

The Supreme Court on Monday ordered that no coercive action be taken against Tata Chemicals over alleged environmental damage to a marine sanctuary in the Gulf of Kutch.

A bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi & V Mohana issued notice on the company's plea challenging a May 25 Gujarat High Court verdict.

The bench sought the Gujarat government's response by November 2 and directed that no coercive action be taken meanwhile.

The high court had dismissed the company's challenge to a 2006 district collector order rejecting its claim over land used for open wastewater channels.

It also directed the Gujarat Pollution Control Board to appoint experts to assess environmental damage and determine remediation and compensation.

LIFE BEGINS POST ASIAD

Indian shuttlers chase glory on BWF circuit

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Vantaa, October 5

Indian shuttlers, led by two-time Olympic medallist PV Sindhu, will look to build on the positives from their Asian Games campaign when they resume their BWF season at the $500,000 Arctic Open Super 500 badminton tournament here on Tuesday.

India's shuttlers returned from the Asian Games with just one medal and four quarterfinal finishes -- two fewer medals than their tally at the previous edition in Hangzhou, China.

Sindhu lost a tight women's singles quarterfinal to China's Chen Yufei to miss out on a medal at Aichi-Nagoya.

However, the 31-year-old former world champion has been in good touch, having won the Japan Open this year. She also had a quarterfinal finish at the World CHampionships in New Delhi.

She is drawn to meet a qualifier.

Kidambi Srikanth and HS Prannoy, who were part of the Indian men's team that won a bronze medal in Japan but did not get a game, will also look to regain their form.

Srikanth, a former world No. 1, registered a runner-up finish at US Open Super 300 this year. He will face Canada's Brian Yang in his opener.

Prannoy, a 2023 Asian Games and World Championships bronze medallist, will meet fourth seed Anders Antonsen of Denmark.

The 34-year-old from Kerala hasn't been in the best of form and has struggled since last year. He recently made a quarterfinal appearance at the Vietnam Open.

In the women's singles, Tanvi Sharma will take on Chinese Taipei's Chiu Pin-Chian.


PV SINDHU

SINDHU LOST A TIGHT WOMEN'S SINGLES QUARTERFINAL TO CHINA'S CHEN YUFEI TO MISS OUT ON A MEDAL AT AICHI-NAGOYA

Medvedev disqualified from China Open

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Beijing, October 5

Daniil Medvedev was disqualified from his semifinal against Novak Djokovic at the China Open after he hit a ball into the stands that struck a spectator in the front row on Monday.

The spectator was helped out of the arena holding a hand over his left eye.

Djokovic was serving for the match at 7-5, 5-3 when Medvedev hit the ball into the stands in apparent frustration.

The incident was reminiscent of when Djokovic was kicked out of the 2020 U.S. Open for accidentally hitting a line judge in the throat with a ball.

Djokovic extended his perfect career record at the China Open to 33-0.

In Tuesday's final, Djokovic will face ninth-ranked Alex de Minaur, who advanced when Hubert Hurkacz retired due to an apparent injury midway through the second set of their semifinal.

De Minaur led 6-4, 3-2 when Hurkacz – who was barely able to run for balls in the second set – stopped playing.

The nature of Hurkacz's injury was not immediately clear. In the third round of the women's tournament, which ends Sunday, six-time Grand Slam champion Iga Swiatek rallied past Donna Vekic 4-6, 7-6 (0), 6-2 and will next meet Iva Jovic, who beat Kamilla Rakhimova 6-1, 7-5.

Elina Svitolina beat Maria Sakkari 6-4, 7-5.

After Asian Games, Indian archers turn focus to Archery Premier League

APL Season 2 will feature 48 archers across 6 franchises

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Hyderabad, October 5

Fresh from the Asian Games high, Indian archery stars will switch from national colours to franchise jerseys when the second season of the Archery Premier League begins here on October 8.

Indian archers registered a nine-medal haul, including five golds, at the continental event.

Kumkum Anil Mohod, 17, became the first Indian to win an individual Asian Games gold in recurve archery, while Jyothi Surekha Vennam helped India defend its women's team gold and Sahil Rajesh Jadhav won two golds.

In Hyderabad, they will carry that form into separate franchise squads, competing alongside and against some of the world's leading archers.

APL Season 2 will feature 48 archers across six franchises, equally divided between men and women in recurve and compound events.

The league's 15-second shot clock adds another test, requiring archers to make quick decisions and deliver under pressure.


Indian archers registered a nine-medal haul, including five golds, at the continental event

Vaibhav needs to spend more time with team: Morkel

Young Sooryavanshi was part of the Asian Games gold medal winning Indian team

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Lucknow, October 5

India's bowling coach Morne Morkel on Monday said teenage sensation Vaibhav Sooryavanshi needs to spend more time with the team even if he is not playing which will only be "great" for the game.

Young Sooryavanshi was part of the Asian Games gold medal winning Indian team and played all the matches, but failed to fire.

And in all likelihood, India will go with Abhishek Sharma and Sanju Samson as openers in the first T20 International against West Indies here on Tuesday.



> **WE ALL KNOW THE TALENT OF VAIBHAV. THE MORE TIME HE SPENDS IN THIS ENVIRONMENT WITH QUALITY PLAYERS, MORE TIME HE TRAINS AT THIS STANDARD, WILL ONLY BE GREAT FOR HIS CRICKET**

"We all know the talent of Vaibhav. The more time he spends in this environment with the quality players, the more time he trains at this standard, will only be great for his cricket," Morkel said at the pre-match press conference.

"And if he's not getting that game time, he's still on a bus, in the dugout, in the hotel with guys with a lot of experience. With him sharing that sort of dressing room and talking to guys, or just actually watching how the guys go through their processes and how they set up innings, will be key for him."

"If you put guys in the right environment and they can ask the right questions and they can observe. So I always challenge them, and for any young player, if he gets game time or if that game time is a little limited, it's still our job to make sure that these guys learn, they grow, and they ask questions."

"I mean that's the combination (Abhishek and Sooryavanshi at the top) they felt for them at the Asian Games. We'll work out tonight what is the best combination for us going into this series. Will they adapt, will they float, will they make any changes, I quite honestly can't give that answer now," he said.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Mohit @ Rahul, S/o: Naresh Kumar, R/o: Jhuggi No-305, Block-19/20, Kalyanpuri, East Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 13167/2025, Dated: 12/05/2025, U/s: 305(B)/217(2) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita 2023, P.S. Hazrat Nizamuddin, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Mohit @ Rahul** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Mohit @ Rahul** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Mohit @ Rahul** of **P.S. Hazrat Nizamuddin, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **06.11.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Manuj Kaushal
Ld. JMFC-03, Room No. 512,
Saket Court, New Delhi

DP/14084/SE/2026

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Invitation of tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

The Divisional Track, Northern Railway, Delhi Division for and on behalf of President of India invites E-Tender on prescribed form for the following work.

Name of work with its location	Supplying and stacking, loading and unloading of 31240 Cum of 65 mm gauge machine-crushed hard stone ballast conforming to Railway Specification IS/RDSO-GE/0001:2023 (February 2023) and latest correction slips, from Ramkumarpura mining area, Village Ramkumarpura, Tehsil Khetri, District Jhunjhunu, Rajasthan, or Khanak mining area (under the control of HSIIDC), Tehsil Tosham, District Bhiwani, Haryana, or any other mining source producing similar quality machine crushed hard stone ballast as above, at Sub Depot No. 2 in Jind Ballast Depot under DEN/Track/DLI. (NIT-08-26-27-WC)
Approx Cost of work	(1) Rs.6,56,93,301.32/-
Earnest Money	(1) Rs.13,13,900.00/-
Date and Starting time for filling e-tender & Tender opening time	Starting time for filling e-tender is **Date-14/10/2026 at 15:00 hrs.** & Tender opening time is **Date-28/10/2026 at 15:00 hrs.**
Website particulars, published e-tender notice location etc. complete details of tender can be seen and web site where the tender form can be downloaded	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in

No: - 128-W/Sr.DEN-C/NIT-08-26-27/WC
Dated: 05/10/2026 **3446/2026**

Serving Customers With A Smile

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Kunal S/o Sh. Mahesh Kumar R/o- H. No.- 07, Harijan Mohalla , Malikpur Kohi, Rangpuri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **case FIR No. 124/2025 U/s 305/331(3)/317(2) BNS PS: Rajinder Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Kunal** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Kunal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Kunal** accused of **FIR No. 124/2025 U/s 305/331(3)/317(2) BNS PS: Rajinder Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **13.01.2027.**

By Order
Ms. Preeti
JMFC-03, Room No. 150
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/13846/CD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **(1) Aamir S/o:** Samsudeen, R/o: Village Dhulawat PO Tauru, Distt Mewat, Haryana **(2) Sakeel S/o:** Sahabuddin **R/o**: H.No. 231 Ward No. 3 Village Kharkari, Near Majid PO Tauru, Distt Mewat, Haryana, **(3) Sher Mohammad @ Sheru, S/o:** Idrish **S/o: R/o:** H.No. 205 Village Kharkari Teh. Tauru, Distt Mewat, Haryana has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **E-FIR No. 11859/26, Dt. 24.05.2026 U/s: 305(B)/317(2)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, PS: Dabri Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **(1) Aamir (2) Sakeel (3) Sher Mohammad @ Sheru,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **(1) Aamir (2) Sakeel (3) Sher Mohammad @ Sheru,** has absconded (or is concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **(1) Aamir (2) Sakeel (3) Sher Mohammad @ Sheru,** of **E-FIR No. 11859/26, Dt. 24.05.2026 U/s: 305(B)/317(2)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, PS: Dabri Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.11.2026**.

By Order
Deepika Yadav
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02
South-West District Court No. 10
Dwarka Court, New Delhi

DP/14164/DW/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Kawaldeep S/o Manjeet Singh R/o H. No. 1 Gali No-1 Maurya Enclave Sant Nagar Burari Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **case FIR No. 192/2024 U/s 324/341/509/354/506/354A/IPC PS: Kashmere Gate, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Kawaldeep** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Kawaldeep** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Kawaldeep** accused of **FIR No. 192/2024 U/s 324/341/509/354/506/354A/IPC PS: Kashmere Gate, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **28.11.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Pooja Yadav
JMFC, Mahila Court-03 Room No. 149
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/ 13926/N/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (2) (ii) Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Aman@Kaku, S/o.** Jogender@Chhedi Lal, **R/o:** H.No. 460, MCD Flats Jahangirpuri, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 6/19, U/s: 394/34 IPC,** registered at **P.S.: Jahangirpuri, Delhi,** and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Aman@Kaku** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Aman@Kaku** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Aman@Kaku, FIR No.: 6/19, U/s: 394/34 IPC,** registered at **P.S.: Jahangirpuri, Delhi,** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **20.11.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
North Court Room No. 06, Ground Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/13969/NW/2026
(Court Matter)

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform public in general that Kotak Mahindra bank Ltd has organized an auction in below mention respect of Vehicles.

VEHICLES FOR SALE

1) ASHOK_LEY AL1015TE REG. NO. UP16MT8230-YOM- 2023
2) TATA MOTORS TATAACE REG. NO. DL1LAL4214-YOM 2023
3) TATA MOTORS TATALP709F REG. NO. UP16JT7574 -YOM- 2022
4) EICHR_VECV PRO6028CBC REG. NO. HR55AT3968-YOM NA
5) TATA MOTORS T_INTRAV20 REG. NO. DL1LAM6448-YOM- NA
6) TATA MOTORS TATA4825B REG.NO. UP13CT6185-YOM- 2023
7) ASHOK_LEY ECOMET1615 REG. NO. UP81DT1244 -YOM- 2021
8) MAH VEERO15XXL REG. NO. DL1LAR4993 -YOM- NA
9) TATA MOTORS T_INTRAV20 REG. NO. DL1LAL5144 -YOM-
10) TATA MOTORS LPT1109T REG. NO. UP14ST3338 -YOM-2021

UNDER HYPOTHECATION WITH M/S KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK IS UNDER SALE IN ITS "AS IS WHERE IS CONDITION" INTERESTED PARTIES CAN GIVE THEIR QUOTATIONS WITH IN 7 DAYS AT BRANCH ADDRESS: KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK 3RD FLOOR, PLOT NO 7, SECTOR 125, NOIDA-201313 OR CONTACT : PUNIT PARASHAR KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK LTD. CONTACT NO. 8377905498 EMAIL-punit.parashar@kotak.com

GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA, HOME DEPARTMENT (PORTS & TRANSPORT)
MAHARASHTRA MARITIME BOARD
Indian Mercantile Chambers, 2nd Floor, Ramjibhai Kamani Marg, Ballard Estate, Mumbai - 400 001. Tel.: 022-69041777 Fax : 022-69041740
Website : https://mahammb.maharashtra.gov.in
Email: ceo.mmb@maharashtra.gov.in / ceommb@gmail.com

E-Tender Notice
Main Portal: https://mahatenders.gov.in

Maharashtra Maritime Board (MMB), Mumbai, hereby invites bids from the eligible agencies for the following work:

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Date and Time
1.	Request for Proposal (RFP) for Operation of Floating Dry Dock (FDD) for Shipbuilding / Ship Repair, in Trombay Channel, Thane Creek, Maharashtra.	01.10.2026 @ 1700 Hrs.

The details can be viewed online and downloaded directly from the Government of Maharashtra E-Tendering Portal **https://mahatenders.gov.in** from **01.10.2026 @ 1700 Hrs** till **15.10.2026 @ 1700 Hrs.**

MMB reserves the right to accept or reject any or all of the bids, without assigning any reason whatsoever.

Sd/-
Date: 01.10.2026
Place: Mumbai
DGIPR/2026/27/3085
Chief Executive Officer,
Maharashtra Maritime Board, Mumbai

Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation Limited
(A Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking)
(ISO 9001 : 2015 Certified)
1st Floor, Udyog Bhawan, Ring Road No.1, Telibandha, Raipur(C.G.) – 492006
CIN : U45203CT1981SG001853, PAN : AABCM6288N, GST Reg. No. 22AABCM6288N5ZY
Phone : 0771-6621000 Fax : 0771-2583794
Website : www.csidc.in, Email address:csidc.cg@nic.in,csidc_raipur@yahoo.com

NOTICE INVITING TENDER [1st Call]
(Through e-Procurement Portal Only)

NIT No. 14/CSIDC/E.E./Division-III/2026-27 Raipur, Dated 01/10/2026

Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation Ltd., Raipur (CSIDC), a Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking constituted under the Companies Act, engaged in Industrial Infrastructure Development & Other Related Activities in the State invites online tender in **"Form-B" (Item Rate Basis)** for the following work :-

S.No	Name of work	Registered Contractor in CGPWD or in appropriate class in other dep't.	Time allowed (including rainy season)	Probable Amount of Contract (PAC) (INR Lacs)	EMD (INR Lacs)	Cost of Tender Document (Including GST 18%)
1	Construction of Sub-Station Building at Pharmaceutical Park, (Sector-22), Nava Raipur, Atal Nagar (C.G.).	Class-D & Above	03 Month	22.27	16,700/-	885/-

The tender document containing detailed terms & conditions, scope of works and other details can be downloaded from the web portal (website) https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in from **01/10/2026** Time 17:01 and shall be submitted online only. Amendment in tender, if any, will only be uploaded on the website and shall not be published in any newspaper.

NOTE: The interested tenderers for online submission of tender may contact CG e-Proc Helpdesk. Operated by **Mjunction Services Limited**, they may reach Helpdesk using 18004199140 (from 9 AM to 11 PM) (therein press 2 for CG e-Proc) or you can email them at Helpdesk.eproc@cgswan.gov.in.

Executive Engineer (Division-III)

samvad 49284/3 कार्यालय एवं दुकान हेतु स्थान उपलब्ध, वेबसाईट देखे www.csidc.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ravi Tope, S/o: Kishan Lal, R/o: D-155 E, Kuwar Singh Nagar, Nangloi, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case No. 3777/2024, U/s: 138 NI Act, Police Station Nangloi, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Ravi Tope** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ravi Tope** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Ravi Tope** of **Police Station Nangloi, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.11.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Tanmay Batham
Ld. JMFC (NI Act)-03, West, Room No. 103,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/14020/OD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Rohit Kumar, S/o Balkishan, R/o D-744, Gali No. 03, Ashok Nagar, Shahdara, Delhi-110093, 2) 1/5895/4, Kabool Nagar, East Rohtash Nagar, Shahdara, Delhi-110032** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CC NI ACT/2239/2022, U/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Mandawali, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Rohit Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Rohit Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Rohit Kumar** accused of **CC NI ACT/2239/2022, U/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Mandawali, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.11.2026.**

By Order - Ms. Shraddha Tripathi
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02, East
Room No. 407, Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/13703/ED/2026



'WAS TERRIFIED FILMING THE VVAANíS UNDERWATER SCENEí

Tamannaah revealed she had to overcome her fear of being underwater for a crucial scene in the film

THE SCENE FEATURES HER CHARACTER FACING A NEAR-DROWNING SITUATION IN THE SONG 'CHHATHI MAIYA'

Tamannaah Bhatia opened up about one of the most challenging sequences she filmed for 'The Vvaan', revealing that she had to overcome her fear of being underwater for a crucial scene in the film. In a recent interview, the actress, who doesn't know how to swim, underwent swimming and deep-sea diving training before filming the sequence. She also credited co-star Sidharth Malhotra, who is a deep-sea diver, for helping her through the demanding shoot.

Speaking to 'Mid-Day', Bhatia recalled her experience of filming the underwater sequence in 'The Vvaan'. The scene features her character facing a near-drowning situation in the song 'Chhathi Maiya', making it particularly challenging for her.

"I cannot swim. I was required to almost drown and I know how to do that very well," she said with a laugh.

The actress admitted that she was initially extremely apprehensive about shooting the sequence because of her inability to swim. She explained that she had to undergo specialised training before stepping into the water for the scene. "I was terrified when I had to do the underwater scene. I had to take swimming and deep-sea diving classes before I began shooting. I have to give credit to Sidharth; he is a deep-sea diver and supported me a lot," she said.



Despite the physically demanding sequence, Tamannaah described her overall experience of working on 'The Vvaan' as deeply satisfying. Addressing reports of an alleged rift between director and actor Sidharth Malhotra, she dismissed the speculation and said she had not found any truth in the rumours. AGENCIES

JANHVI STRONGLY CONDEMNS AI-ALTERED VIDEO



Kapoor called the video 'deeply violating, bordering on sexual assault'

Janhvi Kapoor strongly condemned a disturbing AI-altered video of the song 'Chuttamalle' that is going viral online. In a long 'Instagram' note, she called the clip 'deeply violating' and spoke against the misuse of technology to objectify women. She also thanked her co-star Jr NTR for taking a stand.

The video used AI to change Janhvi's appearance and create sexually explicit imagery that was never part of the original song. In her statement, she wrote, "The criminal misuse of technology to objectify women and circulate fictionalised content without consent is deeply violating, bordering on sexual assault. Almost every woman in my industry has faced some version of this and women everywhere are increasingly being subjected to it." AGENCIES

SHE ALSO THANKED HER 'DEVARA' CO-STAR JR NTR FOR TAKING A STAND

Never my intention to hurt: Sanjay

SANJAY DUTT ON HIS REMARKS IN 'SHEKHAR TONITE SHOW'

NEW DELHI: Bollywood star Sanjay Dutt addressed his 'can't feel that peace in India' remarks on 'Shekhar Tonite Show', saying his comments on the show were made in the context of a scripted conversation without any intention to hurt or offend anyone.

The 67-year-old actor was at the centre of a major online backlash after his comments on the show, hosted by Shekhar Suman, started appearing online. In the show, the actor said, "There should be peace; I can't feel that peace anymore in India."

On Sunday, Dutt posted a statement to clarify that his words were never meant to hurt or offend anyone. "I'd like to clarify that it was never my intention to hurt, offend or disrespect the sentiments of any individual, community or institution," the actor said. PTI



IT SEARCH OPERATIONS RUMOURS?

Rakul Preet Singh denies misleading reports

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 5

Prominent Indian actress Rakul Preet Singh, known for her notable work across Hindi, Telugu and Tamil cinema, officially addressed recent media filings and speculative news reports regarding the Income Tax search operations. A law-abiding taxpayer and self-made artist raised in an Indian Armed Forces family, Singh has maintained a reputation for high professional integrity and strictly compliant financial practices throughout her career. In light of sensationalised and unverified reports circulating across digital and mainstream media channels, the actress released an official statement to set the record straight and safeguard her reputation.



Setting the record straight on the matter, Rakul issued the following statement, "It's heartbreaking to see that there's a growing trend amongst the self-styled online reporters & some mainstream media journalists to sensationalise the news without verifying facts. Let's therefore set the record straight once and for all. The search was not about me. Let it be known that I am from an Armed Forces background & had no godfather in the industry. I have come up through sheer hard work & as a responsible, law-abiding citizen have been paying my due taxes since the age of 20 years."

'I URGE ALL THOSE WHO PUBLISHED THESE FALSE, MALICIOUS AND SPECULATIVE REPORTS TO RETRACT THEM AND CLARIFY THE FACTS,' SAYS SINGH

"I am not involved in any kind of illegal foreign remittance in personal capacity or on behalf of any production house. I would also add here that I do not hold any 'benami' property on behalf of anyone anywhere in the country or abroad. Nor has anyone ever gifted me any property at any time, nor do I accept such expensive gifts as a principle. I urge all those who published these false, malicious and speculative reports to retract them and clarify the facts. I understand that everyone runs a media business. However, big media houses have their own commercial pressures. But it cannot come at the cost of facts. And certainly not at the cost of someone's reputation and livelihood."

SIDDHARTH HAS A RICH INNER WORLD: AMRITA



She plays an IAF officer's wife in 'Operation Safed Sagar'

You share maximum screen space with Siddharth. How was the experience?

It was fantastic. Siddharth has a very rich inner world... He's very well-read and watches a lot of films. His socio-political mind is very active. Also, he doesn't believe in hierarchy.

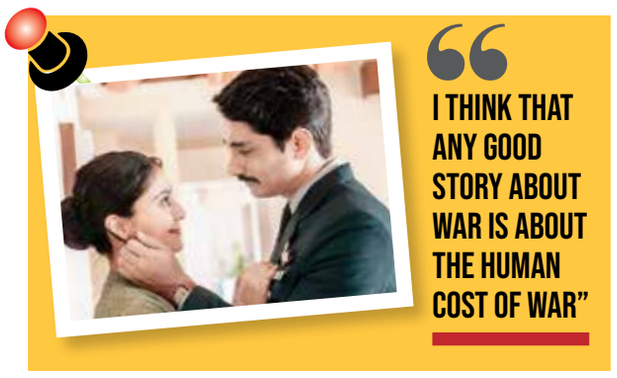
ANINDITA ACHARYA
New Delhi, October 5

In recent times, few OTT shows have earned as much praise as 'Operation Safed Sagar' on 'Netflix' for steering clear of jingoism while telling a moving story about the unsung heroes of the Kargil War. The series also has a strong Bengal connection. Actress Amrita Bagchi plays Alka Ahuja, the wife of Squadron Leader Ajay Ahuja, who lost his life during the war. Born and brought up in Kolkata, Amrita spent some time in Santiniketan before moving across different cities and eventually settling in Mumbai.

An actor, writer, visual artist and filmmaker, Amrita speaks to 'Millennium Post' about her latest work, her journey and the experience of bringing Alka Ahuja's story to the screen.

You play Alka Ahuja, the wife of Squadron Leader Ajay Ahuja, in 'Operation Safed Sagar'. What was your first reaction when you were offered the role and what changed in your understanding of Alka after you actually met her?

Casting director Deepak called me. I had done an audition for him in 2019 for a project that eventually didn't work out. But he remembered the audition. I met the creators and directors, but at that time, I didn't fully understand the scale of the show. At that moment, I only wanted the part. Two months later, I was confirmed. There's been so much gravitas around tragedies and that's how I thought things would happen here as well. But when I met Alka ji (wife of Squadron Leader Ajay Ahuja, the IAF officer), I understood how much wisdom, strength and resilience she has. The grief was omnipresent, but she didn't allow it to make her bitter or cynical.



"I THINK THAT ANY GOOD STORY ABOUT WAR IS ABOUT THE HUMAN COST OF WAR"

The series is about the Kargil War and the Indian Air Force, but Alka's story shifts the focus towards the emotional cost of war for families. Do you think stories about war need to spend more time with the people waiting at home?

I think that any good story about war is about the human cost of war. Talk about any films like 'Full Metal Jacket' or 'Saving Private Ryan' and it talks about the cost of war. And the people waiting at home are the cost of war. They don't get validation for it. Like in the case of Alkaji... She didn't get any validation for it for 25 years, apart from people in the defence forces. Not a lot of people knew about her or the magnitude of what she had been dealing with for so many years.

You have moved between acting, writing, directing and visual art. Do you see yourself primarily as an actor who also makes films or as a filmmaker whose medium happens to include acting?

I feel that I'm an artist first. The medium of expression changes. I don't have much control over my career as an actor. I do have a lot more control in my journey as a filmmaker. But if other people imagine me in their projects and give me good parts, I will get to express myself. I'm saying this more because I don't think I'll ever be able to direct myself. I don't think I have the confidence or skill set to be able to direct myself. I am dependent on other people for my acting journey.

Having grown up between Kolkata and Santiniketan, is there a story from Bengal that has stayed with you long enough to make you want to turn it into a film?

I actually did my second short film, 'Tinctoria', which highlights the tainted history of Indigo slavery. Nabaneeta Dev Sen has written about her solo travel in the 1970s and I love them. Apart from Bengali literature, I want to do something with Durga Puja and its rich history.